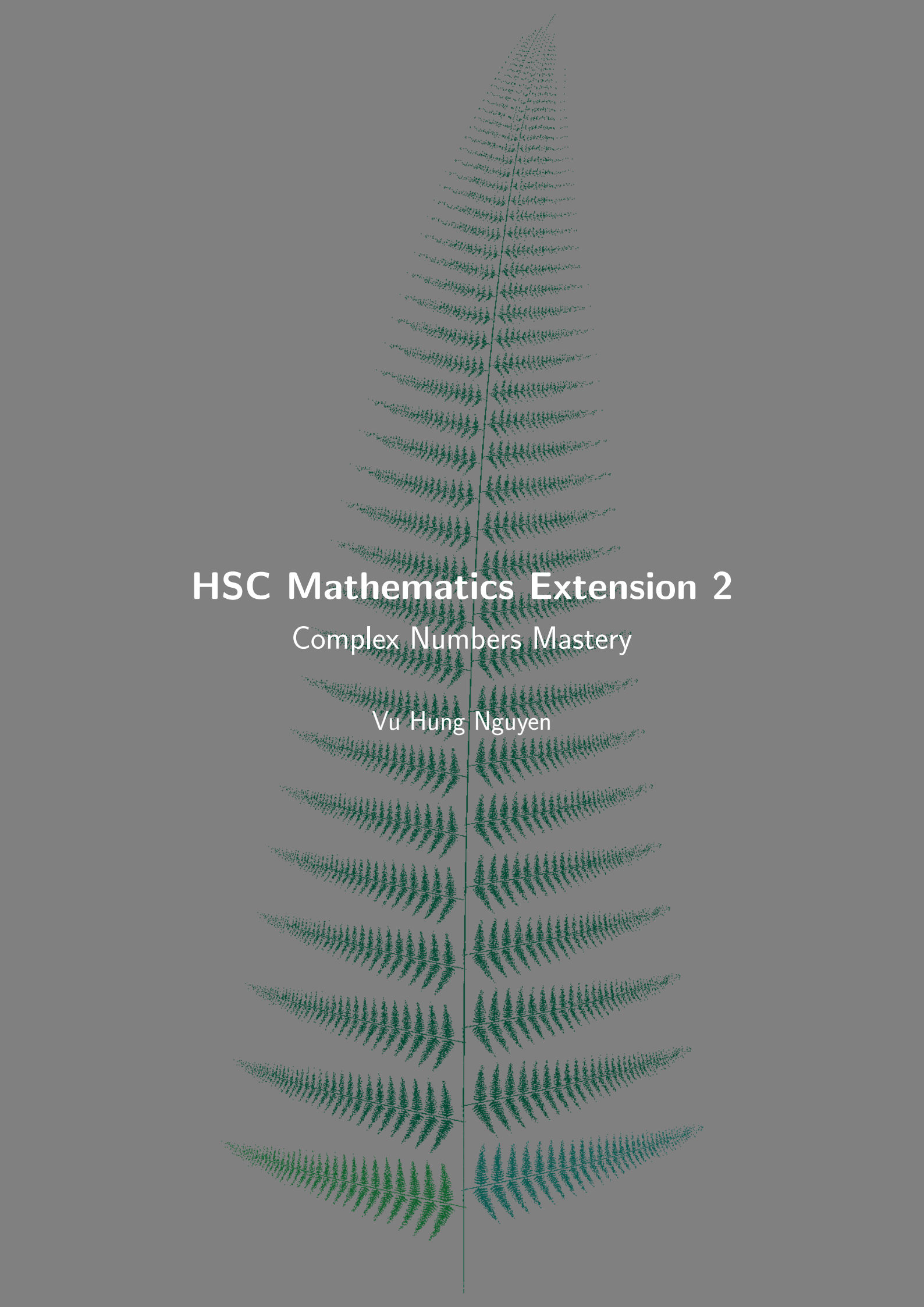




HSC Mathematics Extension 2

Complex Numbers Mastery

Vu Hung Nguyen



Download PDF and resources:

[https://github.com/vuhung16au/
math-olympiad-ml](https://github.com/vuhung16au/math-olympiad-ml)



Read online at Vu's Maths Hub:

<https://vumaths.com/>

“Pure mathematics is, in its way, the poetry of logical ideas.”

Albert Einstein

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1 Introduction

1.1 Project Overview

This booklet compiles high quality complex numbers problems curated specifically for the HSC Mathematics Extension 2 syllabus. Every problem explores fundamental and advanced techniques involving complex numbers—from basic arithmetic and form conversions to De Moivre’s theorem, Argand diagram geometry, polynomial roots, and geometric transformations. Detailed reasoning showcases common techniques such as modulus-argument manipulation, Euler’s formula applications, and geometric interpretations.

1.2 Target Audience

The explanations are crafted for Extension 2 students aiming to deepen their complex number skills. Each solution explicitly states the conversion steps, theorem applications, and geometric reasoning so that high-school learners can follow every transition.

1.3 How to Use This Booklet

- Read the overview and complex numbers primer before attempting the problems.
- Attempt problems in Part 1 without hints; compare against the detailed solutions to understand model reasoning.
- Use the upside-down hints in Part 2 only after making a genuine attempt.
- Revisit problems after a few days and try to re-derive the arguments without notes to reinforce technique.

1.4 Key Topics Covered

This booklet comprehensively covers the following essential topics from the HSC Mathematics Extension 2 Complex Numbers syllabus:

- **Arithmetic and Quadratic Equations:** Operations with complex numbers, solving quadratic equations with complex roots, and understanding the relationship between coefficients and roots.
- **Argand Diagram:** Visual representation of complex numbers as points or vectors in the complex plane, interpreting geometric relationships and transformations.
- **Euler’s Theorem:** The fundamental relationship $e^{i\theta} = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta$ connecting exponential, trigonometric, and complex number representations. *Note:* A major syllabus change is that Euler’s form ($re^{i\theta}$) has been completely removed from the syllabus; it is not examined, but it remains useful and closely connected to higher-education mathematics—keep it in mind.
- **De Moivre’s Theorem:** Computing powers and roots of complex numbers using $(r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta))^n = r^n(\cos(n\theta) + i \sin(n\theta))$, with applications to trigonometric identities.
- **Complex Numbers and Polynomials:** Understanding how complex numbers arise as polynomial roots, factorization over complex numbers, and the Fundamental Theorem of Algebra.

- **Zeros of a Polynomial:** Finding and interpreting zeros, multiplicity of roots, and relationships between roots and coefficients via Vieta's formulas.
- **Complex Coefficients of a Polynomial:** Working with polynomials that have complex coefficients and understanding when conjugate pairs appear.
- **Vector Problems:** Representing complex numbers as vectors, operations such as addition and scalar multiplication, and applications to geometry including rotations and translations.
- **Roots of Complex Numbers:** Finding n -th roots using De Moivre's theorem, understanding the geometric distribution of roots on circles, and unity roots.
- **Curves and Regions:** Describing and sketching loci such as circles, lines, rays, and regions in the complex plane defined by equations and inequalities involving modulus and argument.

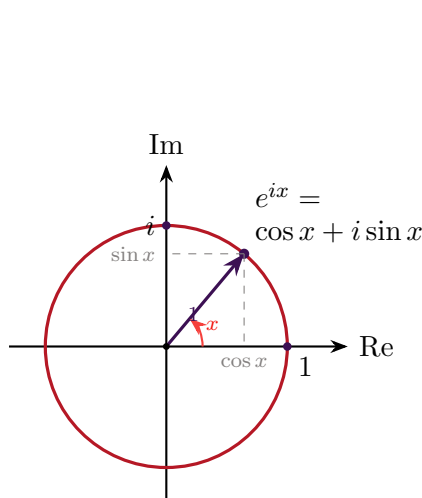
1.5 Complex Numbers Primer

1.5.1 Key Theorems and Formulas

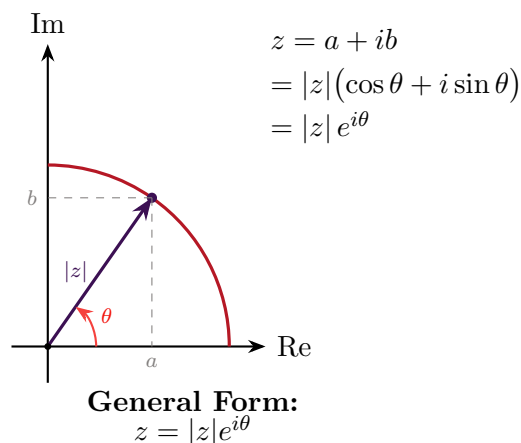
Euler's Theorem:

$$e^{i\theta} = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta$$

This connects exponential form with polar form and is fundamental to many proofs.



Unit Circle: e^{ix}



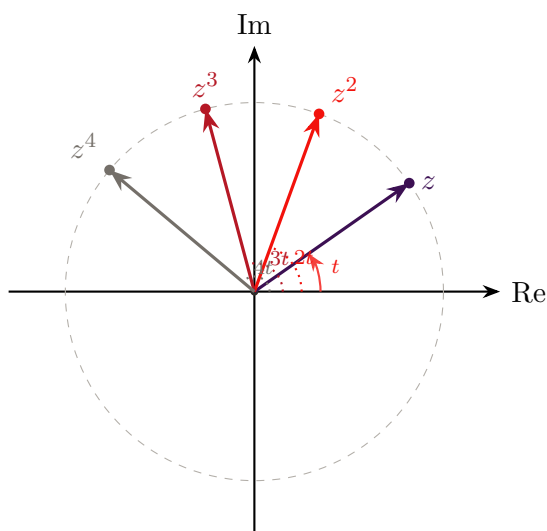
De Moivre's Theorem: For any integer n ,

$$(r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta))^n = r^n(\cos(n\theta) + i \sin(n\theta))$$

or equivalently, $(re^{i\theta})^n = r^n e^{in\theta}$.

This theorem is invaluable for:

- Finding powers of complex numbers
- Finding n -th roots of complex numbers
- Proving trigonometric identities



For $z = e^{it}$ on unit circle:

$z^2 = e^{i(2t)}$ rotates by $2t$

$z^3 = e^{i(3t)}$ rotates by $3t$

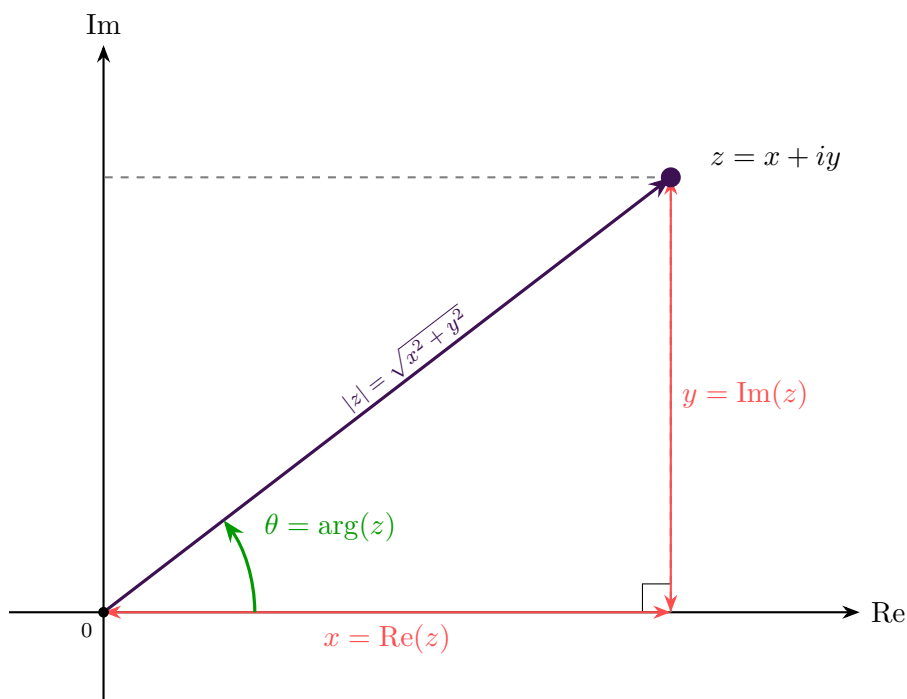
$z^4 = e^{i(4t)}$ rotates by $4t$

Each power multiplies the angle by n .

Powers of z with $|z| = 1$ and $\arg(z) = t$

Modulus and Argument: For $z = x + iy$:

- Modulus: $|z| = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}$
- Argument: $\arg(z) = \tan^{-1}(y/x)$ (with appropriate quadrant adjustments)
- Properties: $|z_1 z_2| = |z_1| |z_2|$, $\arg(z_1 z_2) = \arg(z_1) + \arg(z_2)$ (modulo 2π)



Pythagorean theorem

Modulus:

$$|z| = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}$$

Represents the *distance* from origin to z

Argument:

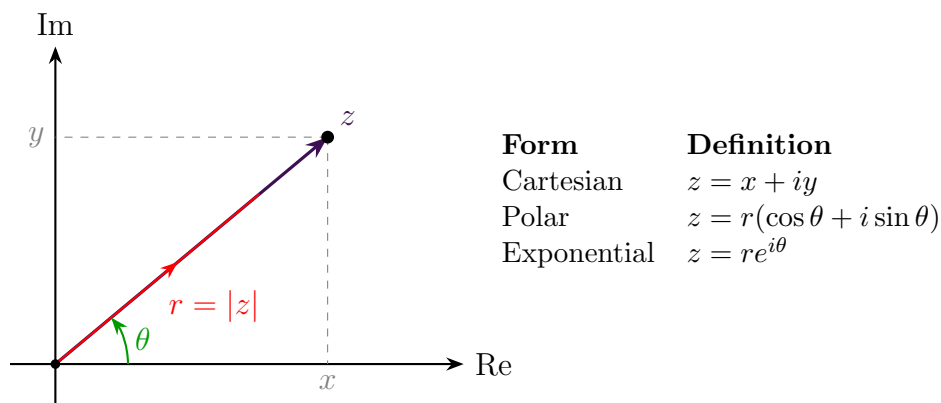
$$\arg(z) = \tan^{-1}\left(\frac{y}{x}\right)$$

Represents the *angle* from positive real axis

1.5.2 Forms of Complex Numbers

Form	Definition
Cartesian	$z = x + iy$
Polar	$z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$, where $r = z $ and $\theta = \arg(z)$
Exponential	$z = re^{i\theta}$

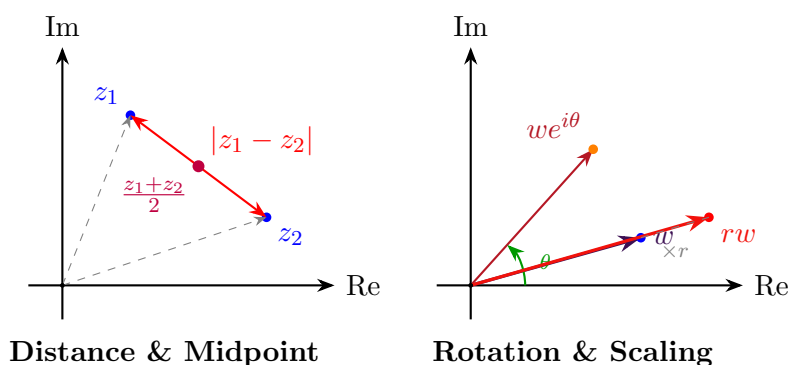
Conversions between these forms are essential skills tested frequently in Extension 2.



1.5.3 Argand Diagram

The Argand diagram visualizes complex numbers as points in the plane, with the real part on the horizontal axis and the imaginary part on the vertical axis. Geometric interpretations include:

- $|z_1 - z_2|$ represents the distance between z_1 and z_2
- $(z_1 + z_2)/2$ represents the midpoint
- Multiplication by $e^{i\theta}$ rotates by angle θ
- Multiplication by r scales by factor r



1.5.4 2D Rotation with Euler's Equation

The multiplication of two complex numbers implies a rotation in 2D space. When we multiply a complex number z by $e^{i\phi}$, it rotates z by angle ϕ while preserving its modulus.

Key Insight: For complex numbers $e^{i\theta}$ and $e^{i\phi}$ on the unit circle:

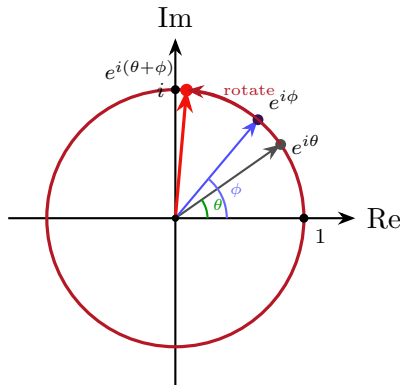
$$e^{i\theta} \cdot e^{i\phi} = e^{i(\theta+\phi)}$$

This shows that multiplication adds the angles, which is equivalent to rotation.

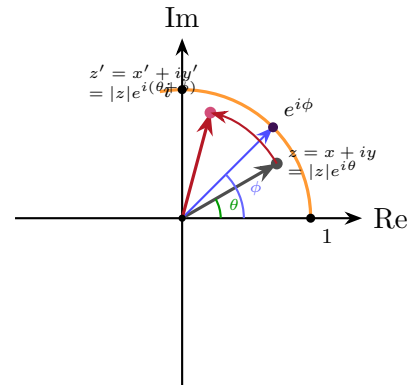
General Rotation: To rotate any complex number $z = x + iy = |z|e^{i\theta}$ by angle ϕ :

$$\begin{aligned}
 z' &= z \cdot e^{i\phi} = |z|e^{i\theta} \cdot e^{i\phi} \\
 &= |z|e^{i(\theta+\phi)} \\
 &= (x + iy)e^{i\phi} \\
 &= (x + iy)(\cos \phi + i \sin \phi) \\
 &= \cos \phi \cdot x - \sin \phi \cdot y + i(\sin \phi \cdot x + \cos \phi \cdot y)
 \end{aligned}$$

Coordinate form (Appendix): An equivalent way to write this rotation using paired real equations is in the Appendix as an out-of-syllabus enrichment note.



Multiplication implies rotation



2D rotation of complex number

Note: This concept extends to 3D rotations using *quaternions*, which use a rotation axis vector $\mathbf{u}$ instead of a single complex number. The quaternion rotation formula is $\cos \theta + \mathbf{u} \sin \theta$ where $\mathbf{u}$ is the unit vector along the rotation axis.

1.5.5 Notation and Conventions

Throughout this booklet:

- $\bar{z}$ denotes the complex conjugate of z
- $\text{Re}(z)$ and $\text{Im}(z)$ denote the real and imaginary parts
- $\arg(z)$ denotes the principal argument in $(-\pi, \pi]$
- Angles are in radians unless otherwise specified

2 Part 1: Problems and Solutions (Detailed)

Part 1 contains three sets of problems—basic, medium, and advanced. Each set provides five problems. For every problem we present a comprehensive solution without any hints so that learners focus on the full reasoning trail.

2.1 Basic Complex Numbers Problems

Problem 2.1: Basic Complex Arithmetic

Let $z = 5 - i$ and $w = 2 + 3i$. What is the value of $2z + \bar{w}$?

Solution 2.1

First, compute $2z$:

$$2z = 2(5 - i) = 10 - 2i.$$

Next, find the conjugate of w :

$$\bar{w} = \overline{2 + 3i} = 2 - 3i.$$

Now add these results:

$$2z + \bar{w} = (10 - 2i) + (2 - 3i) = 12 - 5i.$$

Therefore, $2z + \bar{w} = 12 - 5i$.

Takeaways 2.1

The conjugate of $a + bi$ is $a - bi$. When adding complex numbers, combine real parts with real parts and imaginary parts with imaginary parts.

Problem 2.2: Finding Square Roots

What value of z satisfies $z^2 = 7 - 24i$?

Solution 2.2

Let $z = a + bi$ where a, b are real. Then:

$$z^2 = (a + bi)^2 = a^2 - b^2 + 2abi = 7 - 24i.$$

Equating real and imaginary parts:

$$\begin{aligned} a^2 - b^2 &= 7 \\ 2ab &= -24. \end{aligned}$$

From the second equation: $ab = -12$, so $b = -\frac{12}{a}$.

Substitute into the first equation:

$$a^2 - \left(-\frac{12}{a}\right)^2 = 7 \implies a^2 - \frac{144}{a^2} = 7.$$

Multiply by a^2 :

$$a^4 - 7a^2 - 144 = 0.$$

Let $u = a^2$:

$$u^2 - 7u - 144 = 0 \implies (u - 16)(u + 9) = 0.$$

Since $u = a^2 \geq 0$, we have $u = 16$, so $a^2 = 16$ giving $a = \pm 4$.

If $a = 4$: $b = -\frac{12}{4} = -3$, so $z = 4 - 3i$.

If $a = -4$: $b = -\frac{12}{-4} = 3$, so $z = -4 + 3i$.

Verify: $(4 - 3i)^2 = 16 - 24i + 9i^2 = 16 - 24i - 9 = 7 - 24i$. ✓

Therefore, $z = 4 - 3i$ or $z = -4 + 3i$.

Takeaways 2.2

To find square roots of complex numbers in Cartesian form, let $z = a + bi$ and equate real and imaginary parts after expanding z^2 . This gives a system of two equations in two unknowns.

Problem 2.3: Complex Roots of Quadratics

Given that $z = 3 + i$ is a root of $z^2 + pz + q = 0$, where p and q are real, what are the values of p and q ?

Solution 2.3

Since the polynomial has real coefficients and $z = 3 + i$ is a root, its complex conjugate $\bar{z} = 3 - i$ must also be a root.

By Vieta's formulas:

$$p = -(z_1 + z_2) = -((3 + i) + (3 - i)) = -6,$$

$$q = z_1 \cdot z_2 = (3 + i)(3 - i) = 9 - i^2 = 9 - (-1) = 10.$$

Therefore, $p = -6$ and $q = 10$.

Takeaways 2.3

For polynomials with real coefficients, complex roots occur in conjugate pairs. Use Vieta's formulas: sum of roots $= -p$ and product of roots $= q$ for $z^2 + pz + q = 0$.

Problem 2.4: Powers of i

Write i^9 in the form $a + ib$ where a and b are real.

Solution 2.4

Note the pattern of powers of i :

$$\begin{aligned} i^1 &= i \\ i^2 &= -1 \\ i^3 &= i^2 \cdot i = -i \\ i^4 &= (i^2)^2 = 1 \\ i^5 &= i^4 \cdot i = i \end{aligned}$$

The pattern repeats every 4 powers. To find i^9 :

$$9 = 4 \cdot 2 + 1,$$

$$\text{so } i^9 = i^{4 \cdot 2 + 1} = (i^4)^2 \cdot i = 1^2 \cdot i = i.$$

Therefore, $i^9 = 0 + 1i$, giving $a = 0$ and $b = 1$.

Takeaways 2.4

Powers of i repeat with period 4: $i^1 = i$, $i^2 = -1$, $i^3 = -i$, $i^4 = 1$. Use division by 4 to find $i^n = i^{n \bmod 4}$.

Problem 2.5: Polar Form Conversion

Write $1 + i$ in the form $r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$.

Solution 2.5

For $z = 1 + i$, first find the modulus:

$$r = |z| = \sqrt{1^2 + 1^2} = \sqrt{2}.$$

Next, find the argument. Since z is in the first quadrant:

$$\theta = \arg(z) = \tan^{-1}\left(\frac{1}{1}\right) = \tan^{-1}(1) = \frac{\pi}{4}.$$

Therefore:

$$1 + i = \sqrt{2} \left(\cos \frac{\pi}{4} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{4} \right).$$

Takeaways 2.5

To convert $z = x + iy$ to polar form: (1) Find modulus $r = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}$. (2) Find argument $\theta = \tan^{-1}(y/x)$ (adjust for quadrant). (3) Write $z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$.

2.2 Medium Complex Numbers Problems**Problem 2.6: Rhombus on Argand Diagram**

On the Argand diagram, the complex numbers 0 , $1 + i\sqrt{3}$, $\sqrt{3} + i$ and z form a rhombus. Find z in the form $a + ib$.

Solution 2.6

In a rhombus, opposite sides are parallel and equal in length. Since we have vertices at 0 , $1 + i\sqrt{3}$, $\sqrt{3} + i$, and z , and they form a rhombus with one vertex at the origin, we need z to be the fourth vertex. The rhombus has sides:

- From 0 to $1 + i\sqrt{3}$
- From 0 to $\sqrt{3} + i$
- From $1 + i\sqrt{3}$ to z
- From $\sqrt{3} + i$ to z

For a rhombus with one vertex at the origin, if two adjacent vertices are at w_1 and w_2 , then the fourth vertex is at $w_1 + w_2$ (by the parallelogram law).

Therefore:

$$z = (1 + i\sqrt{3}) + (\sqrt{3} + i) = (1 + \sqrt{3}) + i(\sqrt{3} + 1) = (1 + \sqrt{3})(1 + i).$$

Simplifying:

$$z = 1 + \sqrt{3} + i(1 + \sqrt{3}) = (1 + \sqrt{3})(1 + i).$$

Therefore, $z = (1 + \sqrt{3}) + i(1 + \sqrt{3})$.

Takeaways 2.6

In the Argand diagram, a parallelogram (including rhombus) with vertices at 0 , w_1 , w_2 , and z has its fourth vertex at $z = w_1 + w_2$ by the parallelogram law of vector addition.

Problem 2.7: De Moivre's Theorem for Real Results

Given $-\sqrt{3} - i = 2 \left(\cos \left(-\frac{5\pi}{6} \right) + i \sin \left(-\frac{5\pi}{6} \right) \right)$, show that $(-\sqrt{3} - i)^6$ is a real number.

Solution 2.7

Using De Moivre's theorem:

$$\begin{aligned} (-\sqrt{3} - i)^6 &= \left[2 \left(\cos \left(-\frac{5\pi}{6} \right) + i \sin \left(-\frac{5\pi}{6} \right) \right) \right]^6 \\ &= 2^6 \left(\cos \left(6 \cdot \left(-\frac{5\pi}{6} \right) \right) + i \sin \left(6 \cdot \left(-\frac{5\pi}{6} \right) \right) \right) \\ &= 64 (\cos(-5\pi) + i \sin(-5\pi)). \end{aligned}$$

Now evaluate the trigonometric values:

$$\cos(-5\pi) = \cos(5\pi) = \cos(\pi) = -1,$$

$$\sin(-5\pi) = -\sin(5\pi) = -\sin(\pi) = 0.$$

Therefore:

$$(-\sqrt{3} - i)^6 = 64(-1 + 0i) = -64.$$

Since the imaginary part is zero, $(-\sqrt{3} - i)^6 = -64$ is indeed a real number.

Takeaways 2.7

A complex number in polar form $r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$ raised to power n has argument $n\theta$. If $n\theta$ is a multiple of π , then $\sin(n\theta) = 0$ and the result is real.

Problem 2.8: Division in Polar Form

Let $\alpha = 1 + i\sqrt{3}$ and $\beta = 1 + i$. Find the modulus-argument form of $\frac{\alpha}{\beta}$.

Solution 2.8

First, convert α and β to polar form.

For $\alpha = 1 + i\sqrt{3}$:

$$|\alpha| = \sqrt{1^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2} = \sqrt{1+3} = 2,$$

$$\arg(\alpha) = \tan^{-1}\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{1}\right) = \frac{\pi}{3}.$$

So $\alpha = 2\left(\cos \frac{\pi}{3} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{3}\right)$.

For $\beta = 1 + i$:

$$|\beta| = \sqrt{1^2 + 1^2} = \sqrt{2},$$

$$\arg(\beta) = \tan^{-1}(1) = \frac{\pi}{4}.$$

So $\beta = \sqrt{2}\left(\cos \frac{\pi}{4} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{4}\right)$.

Now compute the quotient:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\alpha}{\beta} &= \frac{2}{\sqrt{2}} \left(\cos \left(\frac{\pi}{3} - \frac{\pi}{4} \right) + i \sin \left(\frac{\pi}{3} - \frac{\pi}{4} \right) \right) \\ &= \sqrt{2} \left(\cos \frac{\pi}{12} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{12} \right).\end{aligned}$$

Takeaways 2.8

For division in polar form: $\frac{r_1(\cos \theta_1 + i \sin \theta_1)}{r_2(\cos \theta_2 + i \sin \theta_2)} = \frac{r_1}{r_2}(\cos(\theta_1 - \theta_2) + i \sin(\theta_1 - \theta_2))$.

Problem 2.9: Powers and Cartesian Form

Express $(\sqrt{3} - i)^7$ in the form $x + iy$.

Solution 2.9

First, convert $\sqrt{3} - i$ to polar form:

$$r = \sqrt{(\sqrt{3})^2 + (-1)^2} = \sqrt{3+1} = 2,$$

$$\theta = \tan^{-1}\left(\frac{-1}{\sqrt{3}}\right) = -\frac{\pi}{6} \text{ (fourth quadrant).}$$

So $\sqrt{3} - i = 2\left(\cos\left(-\frac{\pi}{6}\right) + i \sin\left(-\frac{\pi}{6}\right)\right)$.

Apply De Moivre's theorem:

$$\begin{aligned}(\sqrt{3} - i)^7 &= 2^7 \left(\cos \left(7 \cdot \left(-\frac{\pi}{6} \right) \right) + i \sin \left(7 \cdot \left(-\frac{\pi}{6} \right) \right) \right) \\ &= 128 \left(\cos \left(-\frac{7\pi}{6} \right) + i \sin \left(-\frac{7\pi}{6} \right) \right).\end{aligned}$$

Now evaluate:

$$\begin{aligned}\cos \left(-\frac{7\pi}{6} \right) &= \cos \left(\frac{7\pi}{6} \right) = \cos \left(\pi + \frac{\pi}{6} \right) = -\cos \frac{\pi}{6} = -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}, \\ \sin \left(-\frac{7\pi}{6} \right) &= -\sin \left(\frac{7\pi}{6} \right) = -\sin \left(\pi + \frac{\pi}{6} \right) = -\left(-\sin \frac{\pi}{6} \right) = \frac{1}{2}.\end{aligned}$$

Therefore:

$$(\sqrt{3} - i)^7 = 128 \left(-\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} + i \cdot \frac{1}{2} \right) = -64\sqrt{3} + 64i.$$

Takeaways 2.9

To compute high powers of complex numbers: (1) Convert to polar form. (2) Apply De Moivre's theorem. (3) Simplify the angle using periodicity and reference angles. (4) Convert back to Cartesian form.

Problem 2.10: Locus as a Curve

The point P on the Argand diagram represents $z = x + iy$ satisfying $z^2 + \bar{z}^2 = 8$. Find the equation of the curve in terms of x and y and state what type of curve it is.

Solution 2.10

Let $z = x + iy$, so $\bar{z} = x - iy$.

Then:

$$z^2 = (x + iy)^2 = x^2 - y^2 + 2ixy,$$

$$\bar{z}^2 = (x - iy)^2 = x^2 - y^2 - 2ixy.$$

Therefore:

$$z^2 + \bar{z}^2 = (x^2 - y^2 + 2ixy) + (x^2 - y^2 - 2ixy) = 2(x^2 - y^2) = 8.$$

Simplifying:

$$x^2 - y^2 = 4.$$

This can be rewritten as:

$$\frac{x^2}{4} - \frac{y^2}{4} = 1,$$

which is a rectangular hyperbola with center at the origin, with branches along the x -axis at $x = \pm 2$.

Takeaways 2.10

To find the locus of points satisfying a complex equation: (1) Substitute $z = x + iy$ and $\bar{z} = x - iy$. (2) Expand and simplify. (3) Equate real and imaginary parts. (4) Identify the curve type.

2.3 Advanced Complex Numbers Problems**Problem 2.11: Geometric Proof with Complex Numbers**

Points A and B represent complex numbers z and w on a circle centered at O . Point C represents $z + w$ and also lies on the circle. Show geometrically that $\angle AOB = \frac{2\pi}{3}$.

Solution 2.11

Given that $|z| = |w| = |z + w| = r$ (the radius of the circle), we need to find $\angle AOB$.

Since $OACB$ forms a parallelogram (by vector addition), and we know:

- $OA = |z| = r$
- $OB = |w| = r$
- $OC = |z + w| = r$
- $AC = |w| = r$ (opposite side of parallelogram)
- $BC = |z| = r$ (opposite side of parallelogram)

All sides of the rhombus $OACB$ have length r . Moreover, diagonal OC also has length r .

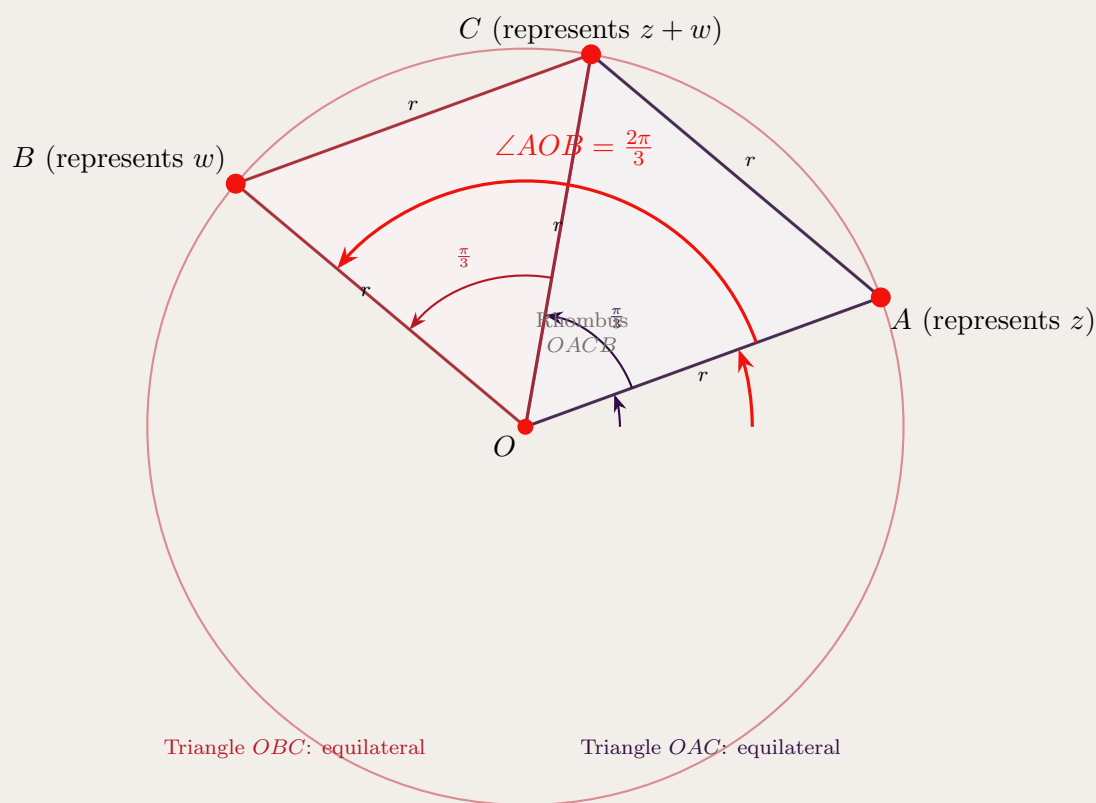
Consider triangle OAC : all three sides have length r (since $OA = AC = OC = r$), so it is equilateral.

Therefore, $\angle AOC = \frac{\pi}{3}$.

Similarly, triangle OBC has $OB = BC = OC = r$, so it is also equilateral. Therefore, $\angle BOC = \frac{\pi}{3}$.

Thus:

$$\angle AOB = \angle AOC + \angle BOC = \frac{\pi}{3} + \frac{\pi}{3} = \frac{2\pi}{3}.$$

**Takeaways 2.11**

When complex numbers are represented geometrically, vector addition corresponds to the parallelogram law. A rhombus with all sides equal to its diagonal consists of two equilateral triangles.

Problem 2.12: Complex Division and Real Parts

Let $z = 2(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$. Show that the real part of $\frac{1}{1-z}$ is $\frac{1-2\cos \theta}{5-4\cos \theta}$.

Solution 2.12

First, compute $1 - z$:

$$1 - z = 1 - 2(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta) = (1 - 2\cos \theta) - 2i \sin \theta.$$

To find $\frac{1}{1-z}$, multiply numerator and denominator by the conjugate of $1 - z$:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{1-z} &= \frac{1}{(1-2\cos \theta) - 2i \sin \theta} \cdot \frac{(1-2\cos \theta) + 2i \sin \theta}{(1-2\cos \theta) + 2i \sin \theta} \\ &= \frac{(1-2\cos \theta) + 2i \sin \theta}{(1-2\cos \theta)^2 + (2\sin \theta)^2}. \end{aligned}$$

Compute the denominator:

$$\begin{aligned} (1-2\cos \theta)^2 + 4\sin^2 \theta &= 1 - 4\cos \theta + 4\cos^2 \theta + 4\sin^2 \theta \\ &= 1 - 4\cos \theta + 4(\cos^2 \theta + \sin^2 \theta) \\ &= 1 - 4\cos \theta + 4 \\ &= 5 - 4\cos \theta. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore:

$$\frac{1}{1-z} = \frac{(1-2\cos \theta) + 2i \sin \theta}{5-4\cos \theta}.$$

The real part is:

$$\operatorname{Re} \left(\frac{1}{1-z} \right) = \frac{1-2\cos \theta}{5-4\cos \theta}.$$

Takeaways 2.12

To find the real part of a complex fraction, rationalize by multiplying by the conjugate of the denominator. Use the identity $\cos^2 \theta + \sin^2 \theta = 1$ to simplify.

Problem 2.13: Finding Complex Roots of Polynomials

Two zeros of $P(x) = x^4 - 12x^3 + 59x^2 - 138x + 130$ are $a + ib$ and $a + 2ib$ where a, b are real and $b > 0$. Find a and b .

Solution 2.13

Since $P(x)$ has real coefficients, complex roots occur in conjugate pairs. If $a + ib$ is a root, then $a - ib$ is also a root. Similarly, if $a + 2ib$ is a root, then $a - 2ib$ is also a root.

Therefore, the four roots are: $a + ib$, $a - ib$, $a + 2ib$, $a - 2ib$.

By Vieta's formulas, the sum of roots equals the negative of the coefficient of x^3 divided by the leading coefficient:

$$(a + ib) + (a - ib) + (a + 2ib) + (a - 2ib) = 4a = 12,$$

so $a = 3$.

The product of roots equals the constant term:

$$[(a + ib)(a - ib)][(a + 2ib)(a - 2ib)] = (a^2 + b^2)(a^2 + 4b^2) = 130.$$

Substituting $a = 3$:

$$(9 + b^2)(9 + 4b^2) = 130.$$

Expand:

$$81 + 36b^2 + 9b^2 + 4b^4 = 130,$$

$$4b^4 + 45b^2 + 81 = 130,$$

$$4b^4 + 45b^2 - 49 = 0.$$

Let $u = b^2$:

$$4u^2 + 45u - 49 = 0.$$

Using the quadratic formula:

$$u = \frac{-45 \pm \sqrt{45^2 + 4 \cdot 4 \cdot 49}}{8} = \frac{-45 \pm \sqrt{2025 + 784}}{8} = \frac{-45 \pm \sqrt{2809}}{8} = \frac{-45 \pm 53}{8}.$$

Since $u = b^2 \geq 0$: $u = \frac{-45+53}{8} = \frac{8}{8} = 1$.

Therefore, $b^2 = 1$, so $b = 1$ (since $b > 0$).

Thus, $a = 3$ and $b = 1$.

Takeaways 2.13

For polynomials with real coefficients, complex roots come in conjugate pairs. Use Vieta's formulas (sum and product of roots) along with conjugate pairing to set up equations for unknown parameters.

Problem 2.14: Trigonometric Identity via Complex Numbers

Show that $\cos 4\theta = \cos^4 \theta - 6 \cos^2 \theta \sin^2 \theta + \sin^4 \theta$.

Solution 2.14

By De Moivre's theorem:

$$(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^4 = \cos 4\theta + i \sin 4\theta.$$

Expand the left side using the binomial theorem:

$$\begin{aligned} (\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^4 &= \sum_{k=0}^4 \binom{4}{k} \cos^{4-k} \theta (i \sin \theta)^k \\ &= \cos^4 \theta + 4i \cos^3 \theta \sin \theta + 6i^2 \cos^2 \theta \sin^2 \theta \\ &\quad + 4i^3 \cos \theta \sin^3 \theta + i^4 \sin^4 \theta \\ &= \cos^4 \theta + 4i \cos^3 \theta \sin \theta - 6 \cos^2 \theta \sin^2 \theta \\ &\quad - 4i \cos \theta \sin^3 \theta + \sin^4 \theta \\ &= (\cos^4 \theta - 6 \cos^2 \theta \sin^2 \theta + \sin^4 \theta) \\ &\quad + i(4 \cos^3 \theta \sin \theta - 4 \cos \theta \sin^3 \theta). \end{aligned}$$

Equating real parts:

$$\cos 4\theta = \cos^4 \theta - 6 \cos^2 \theta \sin^2 \theta + \sin^4 \theta.$$

Takeaways 2.14

De Moivre's theorem combined with binomial expansion provides a systematic way to derive multiple-angle formulas. Equate real and imaginary parts to obtain separate identities for $\cos(n\theta)$ and $\sin(n\theta)$.

Problem 2.15: Conjugate Pairs and De Moivre

Show that

$$(1 + i)^n + (1 - i)^n = 2(\sqrt{2})^n \cos \frac{n\pi}{4}$$

.

Solution 2.15

First, convert $1 + i$ and $1 - i$ to polar form.

For $1 + i$:

$$|1 + i| = \sqrt{2}, \quad \arg(1 + i) = \frac{\pi}{4},$$

$$\text{so } 1 + i = \sqrt{2} \left(\cos \frac{\pi}{4} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{4} \right) = \sqrt{2} e^{i\pi/4}.$$

For $1 - i$:

$$|1 - i| = \sqrt{2}, \quad \arg(1 - i) = -\frac{\pi}{4},$$

$$\text{so } 1 - i = \sqrt{2} \left(\cos \left(-\frac{\pi}{4} \right) + i \sin \left(-\frac{\pi}{4} \right) \right) = \sqrt{2} e^{-i\pi/4}.$$

By De Moivre's theorem:

$$(1 + i)^n = (\sqrt{2})^n e^{in\pi/4} = (\sqrt{2})^n \left(\cos \frac{n\pi}{4} + i \sin \frac{n\pi}{4} \right),$$

$$(1 - i)^n = (\sqrt{2})^n e^{-in\pi/4} = (\sqrt{2})^n \left(\cos \frac{n\pi}{4} - i \sin \frac{n\pi}{4} \right).$$

Adding:

$$\begin{aligned} (1 + i)^n + (1 - i)^n &= (\sqrt{2})^n \left[\left(\cos \frac{n\pi}{4} + i \sin \frac{n\pi}{4} \right) + \left(\cos \frac{n\pi}{4} - i \sin \frac{n\pi}{4} \right) \right] \\ &= (\sqrt{2})^n \cdot 2 \cos \frac{n\pi}{4} \\ &= 2(\sqrt{2})^n \cos \frac{n\pi}{4}. \end{aligned}$$

Takeaways 2.15

For conjugate pairs z and $\bar{z}$ in polar form, $z^n + \bar{z}^n = 2|z|^n \cos(n \arg(z))$ because the imaginary parts cancel. This is useful for simplifying sums involving conjugate powers.

3 Part 2: Problems and Solutions (Concise + Hints)

Part 2 revisits three new sets of problems. Solutions are intentionally briefer to encourage student ownership, and every problem includes an upside-down hint.

3.1 Basic Complex Numbers Problems

Problem 3.1: Multiplication by i as Rotation

Consider the complex number $z = 3 + 2i$ on the Argand diagram. Find the complex number iz and describe its geometric relationship to z .

Hint: Multiplication by i rotates a complex number by 90° counterclockwise about the origin while preserving its modulus. If $z = a + bi$, calculate iz algebraically.

Solution 3.1: Sketch**Algebraic calculation:**

Given $z = 3 + 2i$, we compute:

$$\begin{aligned} iz &= i(3 + 2i) \\ &= 3i + 2i^2 \\ &= 3i + 2(-1) \\ &= -2 + 3i \end{aligned}$$

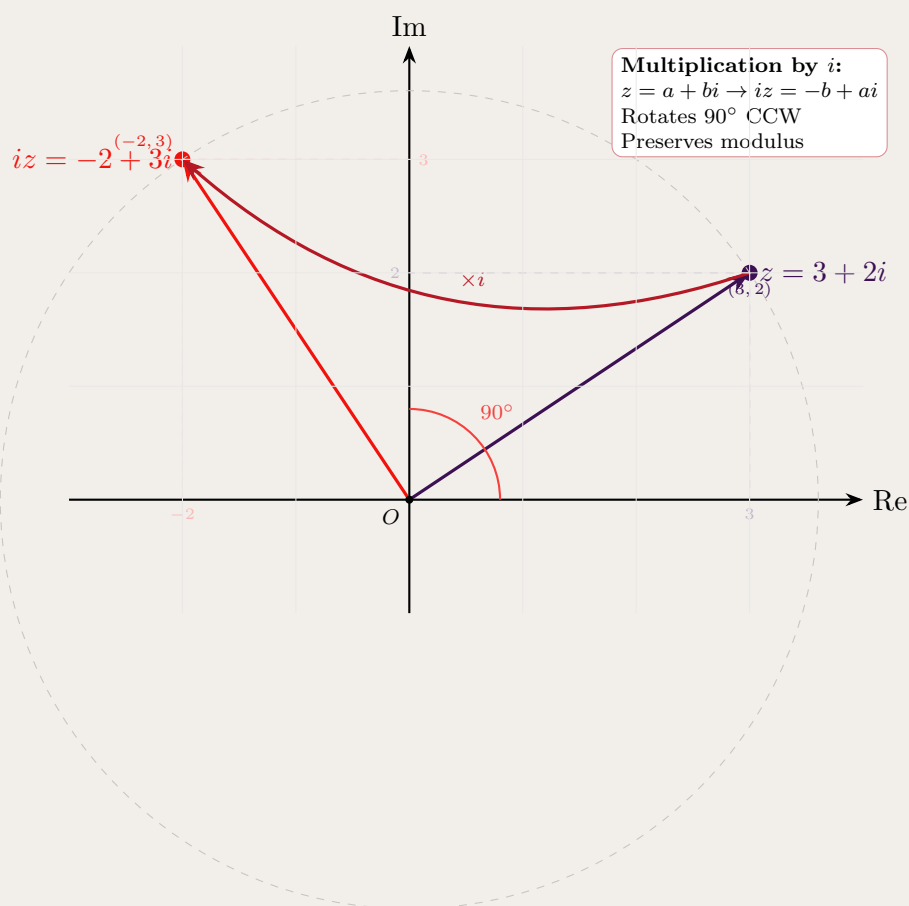
Therefore: $iz = -2 + 3i$

General rule: If $z = a + bi$, then:

$$iz = i(a + bi) = ai + bi^2 = -b + ai$$

This shows that $(a, b) \rightarrow (-b, a)$, which is a 90° counterclockwise rotation.

Verification for our example: - Original point: $z = 3 + 2i$ at position $(3, 2)$ - Rotated point: $iz = -2 + 3i$ at position $(-2, 3)$ - Check: $(3, 2) \rightarrow (-2, 3)$ is correct

**Key observations:**

- The modulus is preserved: $|z| = |iz| = \sqrt{13}$
- The transformation $(a, b) \rightarrow (-b, a)$ is a 90° counterclockwise rotation
- Both points lie on the same circle centered at the origin
- This geometric property makes i rotation in the complex plane

Problem 3.2: Quadrant Determination

The Argand diagram shows z in the first quadrant and w in the second quadrant. Which complex number could lie in the 3rd quadrant: $-w$, $2iz$, $\bar{z}$, or $w - z$?

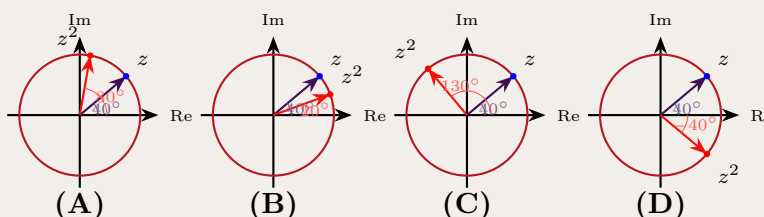
Hint: Check the signs of the real and imaginary parts of each option. Third quadrant means both parts are negative.

Solution 3.2: Sketch

If z is in Q1: $\operatorname{Re}(z) > 0, \operatorname{Im}(z) > 0$. If w is in Q2: $\operatorname{Re}(w) < 0, \operatorname{Im}(w) > 0$. Then $w - z$ has $\operatorname{Re}(w - z) = \operatorname{Re}(w) - \operatorname{Re}(z) < 0$ and $\operatorname{Im}(w - z) = \operatorname{Im}(w) - \operatorname{Im}(z)$ which could be negative if $\operatorname{Im}(z) > \operatorname{Im}(w)$. Answer: (D) $w - z$.

Problem 3.3: Doubling the Argument

A complex number z is on the unit circle at angle $\theta = 40^\circ$. Which diagram best shows the location of $\frac{z^2}{|z|}$?



Hint: If $z = e^{i\theta}$, then $z^2 = e^{i2\theta}$ and $|z| = 1$.

Solution 3.3: Sketch

Since $|z| = 1$, we have $\frac{z^2}{|z|} = z^2$. By De Moivre's theorem, z^2 has the same modulus but double the argument. If z is at angle $\theta = 40^\circ$, then z^2 is at angle $2\theta = 80^\circ$.

Analysis of options:

- (A) **CORRECT:** Shows z^2 at angle $80^\circ = 2 \times 40^\circ$. This correctly applies De Moivre's theorem.
- (B) Incorrect: Shows z^2 at angle $20^\circ = 40^\circ/2$. This halves the angle instead of doubling it.
- (C) Incorrect: Shows z^2 at angle $130^\circ = 40^\circ + 90^\circ$. This adds a fixed angle, which would represent multiplication by i .
- (D) Incorrect: Shows z^2 at angle -40° . This reflects across the real axis, which would give the conjugate $\bar{z}$.

Answer: (A)

Problem 3.4: Polynomial with Complex Zero

Which polynomial could have $2 + i$ as a zero, given that k is real?

- (A) $x^3 - 4x^2 + kx$
- (B) $x^3 - 4x^2 + kx + 5$
- (C) $x^3 - 5x^2 + kx$
- (D) $x^3 - 5x^2 + kx + 5$

Hint: If the polynomial has real coefficients and $2 + i$ is a root, then $2 - i$ must also be a root. The sum of these roots is 4.

Solution 3.4: Sketch

Roots $2 + i$ and $2 - i$ sum to 4. Let the third root be r . Then sum of all roots = $4 + r$. From the coefficient of x^2 : $-(4 + r) = -4$ or -5 . If -4 , then $r = 0$, giving option (A) or (B). Check: $(x)(x^2 - 4x + 5) = x^3 - 4x^2 + 5x$, but we need $+5$ constant. Answer: (B).

Problem 3.5: Squaring Complex Numbers

Let $z = 3 + i$ and $w = 2 - 5i$. Find z^2 in the form $x + iy$.

Hint: Use $(a + bi)^2 = a^2 - b^2 + 2abi$.

Solution 3.5: Sketch

$$z^2 = (3 + i)^2 = 9 + 6i + i^2 = 9 + 6i - 1 = 8 + 6i.$$

Problem 3.6: Conjugate Subtraction

Let $z = 4 + i$ and $w = \bar{z}$. Find $w - z$ in the form $x + iy$.

Hint: If $z = 4 + i$, then $\bar{z} = 4 - i$.

Solution 3.6: Sketch

$$w = \bar{z} = 4 - i. \text{ Then } w - z = (4 - i) - (4 + i) = -2i.$$

Problem 3.7: Division by Complex Number

Let $z = 2 + i$. Find $\frac{4}{z}$ in the form $x + iy$.

Hint: Multiply numerator and denominator by $\bar{z} = 2 - i$.

Solution 3.7: Sketch

$$\frac{4}{2+i} = \frac{4(2-i)}{(2+i)(2-i)} = \frac{8-4i}{4-i^2} = \frac{8-4i}{5} = \frac{8}{5} - \frac{4}{5}i.$$

Problem 3.8: Complex Multiplication

Let $z = 3 + i$ and $w = 1 - i$. Find zw in the form $x + iy$.

Hint: Use FOIL: $(a + bi)(c + di) = ac + bd + (ad + bc)i$.

Solution 3.8: Sketch

$$zw = (3 + i)(1 - i) = 3 - 3i + i - i^2 = 3 - 2i + 1 = 4 - 2i.$$

Problem 3.9: Another Division

Let $w = 1 - i$. Find $\frac{6}{w}$ in the form $x + iy$.

Hint: Multiply by conjugate: $\bar{w} = 1 + i$.

Solution 3.9: Sketch

$$\frac{6}{1-i} = \frac{6(1+i)}{(1-i)(1+i)} = \frac{6+6i}{1-i^2} = \frac{6+6i}{2} = 3 + 3i.$$

Problem 3.10: Dividing by Conjugate

Let $z = 4 + i$ and $w = \bar{z}$. Find $\frac{z}{w}$ in the form $x + iy$.

Hint: $w = 4 - i$, so $\frac{z}{w} = \frac{4+i}{4-i}$.

Solution 3.10: Sketch

$$\frac{4+i}{4-i} = \frac{(4+i)(4+i)}{(4-i)(4+i)} = \frac{16+8i+i^2}{16-i^2} = \frac{15+8i}{17} = \frac{15}{17} + \frac{8}{17}i.$$

Problem 3.11: Modulus from Polar Form

Let $z = \frac{1}{2}(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$. Find $|z|$.

Hint: For $z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$, we have $|z| = r$.

Solution 3.11: Sketch

$$|z| = \frac{1}{2}.$$

Problem 3.12: Division in Cartesian Form

Express $\frac{3-i}{2+i}$ in the form $x + iy$.

Hint: Multiply by $\frac{2-i}{2-i}$.

Solution 3.12: Sketch

$$\frac{3-i}{2+i} = \frac{(3-i)(2-i)}{(2+i)(2-i)} = \frac{6-3i-2i+i^2}{4-i^2} = \frac{5-5i}{5} = 1-i.$$

Problem 3.13: Addition with Conjugate

Let $z = 1 + 3i$ and $w = 2 - i$. Find $z + \bar{w}$.

Hint: $\bar{w} = 2 + i$.

Solution 3.13: Sketch

$$z + \bar{w} = (1 + 3i) + (2 + i) = 3 + 4i.$$

Problem 3.14: Product with Conjugate

Evaluate $w\bar{z}$ given $w = -1 + 4i$ and $z = 2 - i$.

Hint: $\bar{z} = 2 + i$.

Solution 3.14: Sketch

$$w\bar{z} = (-1 + 4i)(2 + i) = -2 - i + 8i + 4i^2 = -2 + 7i - 4 = -6 + 7i.$$

Problem 3.15: Polar Form of Given Number

Let $w = 1 + i\sqrt{3}$. Express w in modulus-argument form.

Hint: $|w| = \sqrt{1+3} = 2$, and $\arg(w) = \tan^{-1}(\sqrt{3}/1) = \pi/3$.

Solution 3.15: Sketch

$$w = 2 \left(\cos \frac{\pi}{3} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{3} \right).$$

Problem 3.16: Showing a Power is Real

Let $z = \sqrt{3} - i$. Show that z^6 is real.

Hint: Convert to polar form: $z = 2(\cos(-\pi/6) + i \sin(-\pi/6))$.

Solution 3.16: Sketch

$$z^6 = 2^6(\cos(-\pi) + i \sin(-\pi)) = 64(-1 + 0i) = -64, \text{ which is real.}$$

Problem 3.17: Principal Argument

Evaluate $\text{Arg}(z)$ for $z = -\sqrt{3} + i$.

Hint: z is in the second quadrant. Use $\tan \theta = \frac{-1}{-\sqrt{3}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$.

Solution 3.17: Sketch

Reference angle is $\pi/6$. Since z is in Q2, $\text{Arg}(z) = \pi - \pi/6 = \frac{5\pi}{6}$.

Problem 3.18: Polynomial with Complex Root

It is given that $z = 2 + i$ is a root of $z^3 + az^2 - 7z + 15 = 0$, where a is a real number. What is the value of a ?

- (A) -1
- (B) 1
- (C) 7
- (D) -7

Hint: Since the polynomial has real coefficients and $2 + i$ is a root, then $2 - i$ must also be a root. Use Vieta's formulas or substitute the root directly.

Solution 3.18: Sketch**Method 1: Direct substitution**

Since $z = 2 + i$ is a root, substitute into the equation:

$$(2 + i)^3 + a(2 + i)^2 - 7(2 + i) + 15 = 0$$

Calculate $(2 + i)^2$:

$$(2 + i)^2 = 4 + 4i + i^2 = 4 + 4i - 1 = 3 + 4i$$

Calculate $(2 + i)^3 = (2 + i)(3 + 4i)$:

$$(2 + i)(3 + 4i) = 6 + 8i + 3i + 4i^2 = 6 + 11i - 4 = 2 + 11i$$

Substitute into the equation:

$$\begin{aligned} (2 + 11i) + a(3 + 4i) - 7(2 + i) + 15 &= 0 \\ (2 + 11i) + (3a + 4ai) + (-14 - 7i) + 15 &= 0 \\ (2 + 3a - 14 + 15) + (11 + 4a - 7)i &= 0 \\ (3 + 3a) + (4 + 4a)i &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

For this to equal zero, both real and imaginary parts must be zero:

$$\text{Real part: } 3 + 3a = 0 \implies a = -1$$

$$\text{Imaginary part: } 4 + 4a = 0 \implies a = -1$$

Method 2: Using conjugate roots

Since the polynomial has real coefficients, if $2 + i$ is a root, then $2 - i$ is also a root.

Let the third root be r . By Vieta's formulas, the sum of roots equals $-a$:

$$(2 + i) + (2 - i) + r = -a$$

$$4 + r = -a$$

The product of roots equals -15 :

$$(2 + i)(2 - i) \cdot r = -15$$

$$(4 - i^2) \cdot r = -15$$

$$5r = -15$$

$$r = -3$$

Therefore: $4 + (-3) = -a \implies a = -1$

Answer: (A) $a = -1$

Problem 3.19: Power Using De Moivre's Theorem

- (i) Write the number $\sqrt{3} + i$ in modulus-argument form.
- (ii) Hence, or otherwise, write $(\sqrt{3} + i)^7$ in exact Cartesian form.

Hint: For part (i): Find $|z| = \sqrt{3+1} = 2$ and $\arg(z) = \tan^{-1}(1/\sqrt{3}) = \pi/6$. For part (ii): Use De Moivre's theorem to find $(re^{i\theta})^7 = r^7 e^{i7\theta}$.

Solution 3.19: Sketch**Part (i): Convert to modulus-argument form**Let $z = \sqrt{3} + i$.

Calculate the modulus:

$$|z| = \sqrt{(\sqrt{3})^2 + 1^2} = \sqrt{3+1} = \sqrt{4} = 2$$

Calculate the argument. Since z is in the first quadrant:

$$\arg(z) = \tan^{-1}\left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}\right) = \tan^{-1}\left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}\right) = \frac{\pi}{6}$$

Therefore, in modulus-argument form:

$$z = 2\left(\cos \frac{\pi}{6} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{6}\right) = 2e^{i\pi/6}$$

Part (ii): Calculate z^7 using De Moivre's theorem

By De Moivre's theorem:

$$\begin{aligned} z^7 &= \left[2\left(\cos \frac{\pi}{6} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{6}\right)\right]^7 \\ &= 2^7 \left(\cos \frac{7\pi}{6} + i \sin \frac{7\pi}{6}\right) \\ &= 128 \left(\cos \frac{7\pi}{6} + i \sin \frac{7\pi}{6}\right) \end{aligned}$$

Calculate the trigonometric values. The angle $\frac{7\pi}{6}$ is in the third quadrant (reference angle $\frac{\pi}{6}$):

$$\cos \frac{7\pi}{6} = -\cos \frac{\pi}{6} = -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$$

$$\sin \frac{7\pi}{6} = -\sin \frac{\pi}{6} = -\frac{1}{2}$$

Therefore:

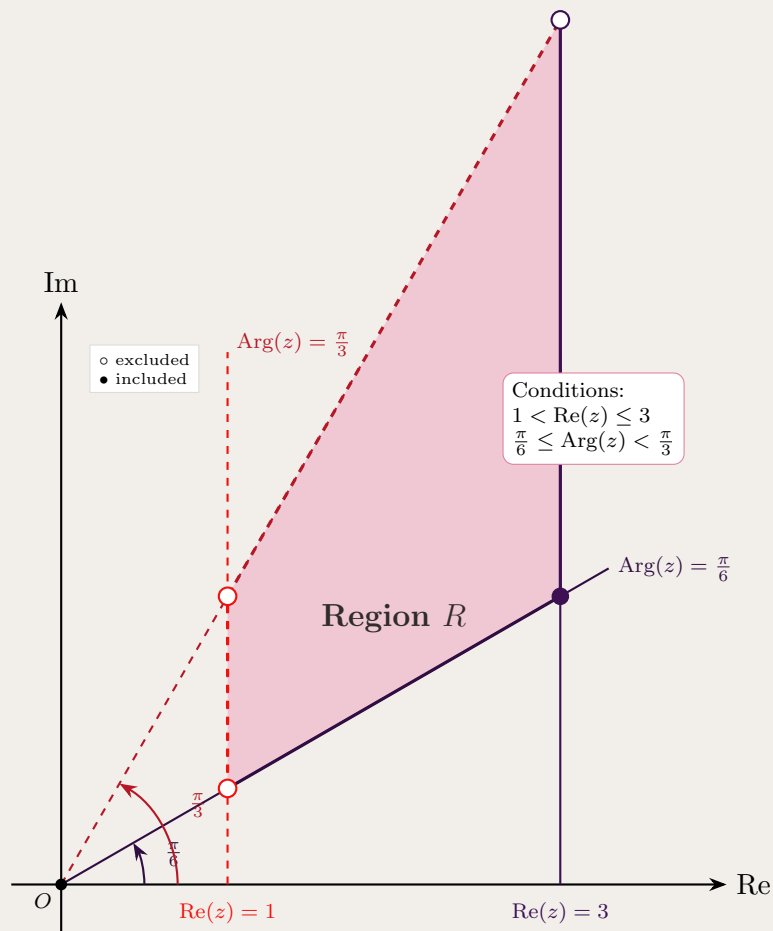
$$\begin{aligned} z^7 &= 128 \left(-\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} + i\left(-\frac{1}{2}\right)\right) \\ &= 128 \left(-\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} - \frac{i}{2}\right) \\ &= -64\sqrt{3} - 64i \end{aligned}$$

Answer: $(\sqrt{3} + i)^7 = -64\sqrt{3} - 64i$ **Verification (optional):** We can verify that $|z^7| = |z|^7 = 2^7 = 128$ and $\arg(z^7) = 7\arg(z) = 7 \cdot \frac{\pi}{6} = \frac{7\pi}{6}$ (in the range $(-\pi, \pi]$).**3.2 Medium Complex Numbers Problems****Problem 3.20: Region with Real and Argument Constraints**Let R be the region in the complex plane defined by $1 < \operatorname{Re}(z) \leq 3$ and $\frac{\pi}{6} \leq \operatorname{Arg}(z) < \frac{\pi}{3}$. Sketch this region.

Hint: The region is bounded by two vertical lines ($x = 1$ and $x = 3$) and two rays from the origin at angles $\pi/6$ and $\pi/3$.

Solution 3.20: Sketch

Draw vertical lines at $x = 1$ (dashed, excluded) and $x = 3$ (solid, included). Draw rays from origin at angles 30° (solid) and 60° (dashed). The region is the intersection in the first quadrant.



Problem 3.21: The Spira Mirabilis - Eadem mutata resurgo

"Eadem mutata resurgo" — "Changed, I rise again the same."

This phrase was chosen by mathematician Jacob Bernoulli to describe the Logarithmic Spiral, a curve that retains its shape as it scales.

In this problem, you will explore the properties of a (discrete) logarithmic spiral defined in the complex plane, which exhibits self-similarity and convergent path length, a pattern often seen in nature such as in shells, storm systems, and galaxies.

Let $\{z_n\}$ be a sequence of complex numbers defined by the initial value $z_0 = 1$ and the recurrence relation:

$$z_{n+1} = \left(\frac{1+i}{2}\right) z_n$$

- (i) Prove that for all $n \geq 0$, the triangle formed by the origin O and two consecutive terms, $\triangle Oz_n z_{n+1}$, is similar to the triangle $\triangle Oz_{n+1} z_{n+2}$.
- (ii) Find the length of the polygonal spiral path connecting the points $z_0, z_1, z_2, \dots$:

$$L = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} |z_{n+1} - z_n|$$

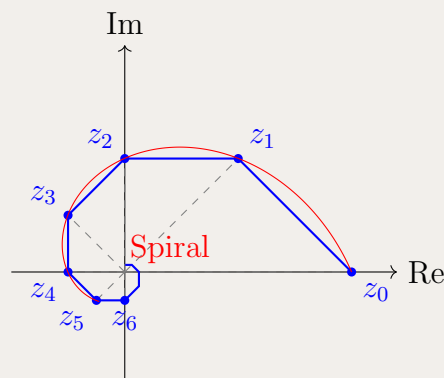
- (iii) Show that the points z_n lie on the continuous logarithmic spiral defined by the polar equation:

$$r = e^{-k\theta}$$

and find the exact value of the constant k .

- (iv) Let $R = |z_0|$. Prove that the ratio of the total path length to the initial radius is given by:

$$\frac{L}{R} = \cot\left(\frac{\pi}{8}\right)$$



Hint:

- **Part (i):** Use the properties of complex multiplication. If $z_{n+1} = wz_n$, then multiplication by w scales the modulus by $|w|$ and rotates the argument by $\arg(w)$. Compare the ratios of sides and included angles for the two triangles.
- **Part (ii):** The sequence of segment lengths forms a geometric progression. First, find $|z_{n+1} - z_n|$ in terms of $|z_n|$ and the constant multiplier.
- **Part (iii):** Express the multiplier in exponential form $re^{i\phi}$. This allows you to write z_n as a function of n . Eliminate n to relate the modulus (radius) directly to the argument (angle).
- **Part (iv):** Calculate $\cot(\pi/8)$ exactly using half-angle formulae and compare it to your result from Part (ii).

Solution 3.21: Detailed

Let $w = \frac{1+i}{2}$. Then $|w| = \frac{|1+i|}{2} = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$ and $\arg(w) = \frac{\pi}{4}$.

(i) Self-similarity. Since $z_{n+1} = wz_n$, multiplication by w maps the vector Oz_n to Oz_{n+1} by scaling all lengths by $|w|$ and rotating all directions by $\arg(w)$. Hence both the included angle $\angle z_n Oz_{n+1}$ and the ratio $\frac{|Oz_{n+1}|}{|Oz_n|}$ are constant and equal to $\arg(w)$ and $|w|$, respectively. By SAS, $\triangle Oz_n z_{n+1} \sim \triangle Oz_{n+1} z_{n+2}$.

(ii) Total polygonal length. The n -th segment length is

$$\ell_n = |z_{n+1} - z_n| = |wz_n - z_n| = |z_n| |w - 1|.$$

With $|z_n| = |w|^n = (1/\sqrt{2})^n$ and

$$|w - 1| = \left| \frac{1+i}{2} - 1 \right| = \left| -\frac{1}{2} + \frac{i}{2} \right| = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}},$$

we get $\ell_n = (1/\sqrt{2})^{n+1}$. Therefore

$$L = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \ell_n = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \right)^{n+1} = \frac{\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}}{1 - \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2} - 1} = \sqrt{2} + 1.$$

(iii) Continuous spiral form. Write $w = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}e^{i\pi/4}$. Then

$$z_n = w^n = \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \right)^n e^{in\pi/4},$$

so in polar form $r_n = 2^{-n/2}$ and $\theta_n = \frac{n\pi}{4}$. Eliminating n via $n = \frac{4\theta}{\pi}$ gives

$$r = 2^{-\frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{4\theta}{\pi}} = 2^{-\frac{2\theta}{\pi}} = e^{-\frac{2\ln 2}{\pi} \theta},$$

hence $r = e^{-k\theta}$ with $k = \frac{2\ln 2}{\pi}$.

(iv) Ratio as a trig value. With $R = |z_0| = 1$, we have $\frac{L}{R} = \sqrt{2} + 1$. To link this to $\cot(\frac{\pi}{8})$, set $t = \tan(\frac{\pi}{8})$ and use the double-angle identity

$$\tan(2A) = \frac{2 \tan A}{1 - \tan^2 A}, \quad A = \frac{\pi}{8},$$

together with $\tan(\frac{\pi}{4}) = 1$. Then

$$1 = \frac{2t}{1 - t^2} \implies t^2 + 2t - 1 = 0 \implies t = \sqrt{2} - 1 \quad (\text{positive since } \frac{\pi}{8} \in (0, \frac{\pi}{4})).$$

Thus

$$\cot\left(\frac{\pi}{8}\right) = \frac{1}{\tan(\frac{\pi}{8})} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2} - 1} = \sqrt{2} + 1 = \frac{L}{R}.$$

Takeaways 3.1

- Multiplication by a complex constant produces a fixed rotation and scaling. Here, $z_{n+1} = wz_n$ with $w = \frac{1+i}{2}$ rotates by $\arg(w) = \frac{\pi}{4}$ and scales by $|w| = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$.
- The spiral path length is an infinite geometric series. Although the path has infinitely many segments, the total length is finite.
- The sequence $\{z_n\}$ gives a discrete model of a logarithmic spiral, connecting algebraic recurrence with a continuous polar equation.
- The logarithmic spiral is self-similar and appears in natural and applied contexts, including shells, galaxies, and antenna geometry.

Problem 3.22: Statement Analysis

Which statement about complex numbers is true?

- (A) For $z = x + iy$, the argument is given by $\arg(z) = \arctan(y/x)$ for all $z \neq 0$.
- (B) For any two complex numbers z_1 and z_2 , we have $\text{Arg}(z_1 z_2) = \text{Arg}(z_1) + \text{Arg}(z_2)$.
- (C) If two complex numbers have the same modulus and their arguments satisfy $\theta_1 = \theta_2 + 2\pi k$ for some integer k , then they are equal (modulo 2π).
- (D) For $z = x + iy$ with $x > 0$, the argument is $\arg(z) = \arctan(y/x)$.

Hint: Check each statement. Remember that $\text{Arg}(z_1 z_2) = \text{Arg}(z_1) + \text{Arg}(z_2)$ only modulo 2π .

Solution 3.22: Sketch

- **(A) False:** The formula $\arg(z) = \arctan(y/x)$ doesn't account for the quadrant. For example, if $z = -1 + i$, then $\arctan(-1) = -\pi/4$, but the actual argument is $3\pi/4$ (in the second quadrant).
- **(B) False:** Principal argument addition requires modulo 2π adjustment. For instance, if $\text{Arg}(z_1) = 3\pi/4$ and $\text{Arg}(z_2) = 3\pi/4$, then $\text{Arg}(z_1) + \text{Arg}(z_2) = 3\pi/2$, but we need to adjust to the principal range $(-\pi, \pi]$, giving $\text{Arg}(z_1 z_2) = -\pi/2$.
- **(C) True (with proper interpretation):** If $|z_1| = |z_2|$ and $\arg(z_1) = \arg(z_2) + 2\pi k$ for integer k , then $z_1 = z_2$ since arguments that differ by $2\pi k$ represent the same direction.
- **(D) True (but limited):** This is correct when $x > 0$ (first and fourth quadrants), as the $\arctan$ function gives the correct argument in these quadrants without adjustment.

Answer: The best answer is **(D)** for its specific domain, though **(C)** is also correct if “equality” means modulo 2π . Statement **(D)** is the most straightforward true statement.

Problem 3.23: Roots of Unity Application

Suppose that $x + \frac{1}{x} = -1$. What is the value of $x^{2028} + \frac{1}{x^{2028}}$?

Hint: Solve $x^2 + x + 1 = 0$ to find $x = e^{i2\pi/3}$ or $x = e^{-i2\pi/3}$. These are cube roots of unity.

Solution 3.23: Sketch

$x^2 + x + 1 = 0$ gives $x = e^{\pm i2\pi/3}$. Since $x^3 = 1$, we have $x^{2028} = x^{3 \cdot 676} = 1$. Thus $x^{2028} + \frac{1}{x^{2028}} = 1 + 1 = 2$.

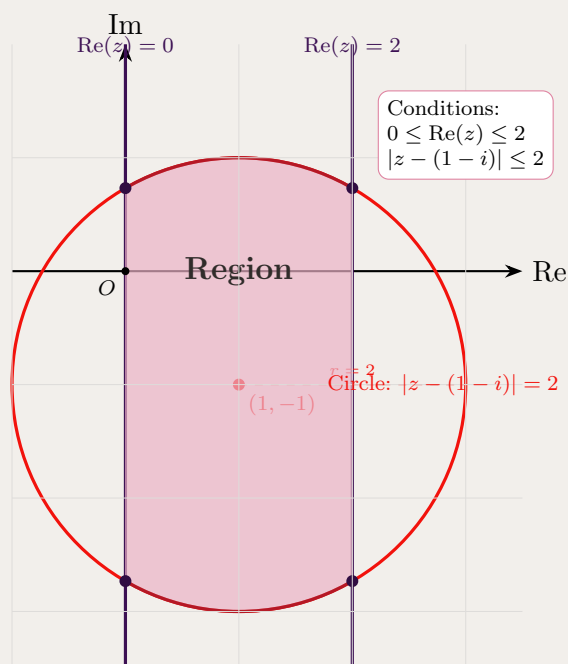
Problem 3.24: Shading a Region

On an Argand diagram, shade the region where $0 \leq \operatorname{Re}(z) \leq 2$ and $|z - (1 - i)| \leq 2$ both hold.

Hint: The first inequality is a vertical strip. The second is a disk centered at $(1, -1)$ with radius 2.

Solution 3.24: Sketch

Draw vertical lines at $x = 0$ and $x = 2$. Draw circle centered at $(1, -1)$ with radius 2. Shade the intersection.



Problem 3.25: Shifted Reciprocal Locus

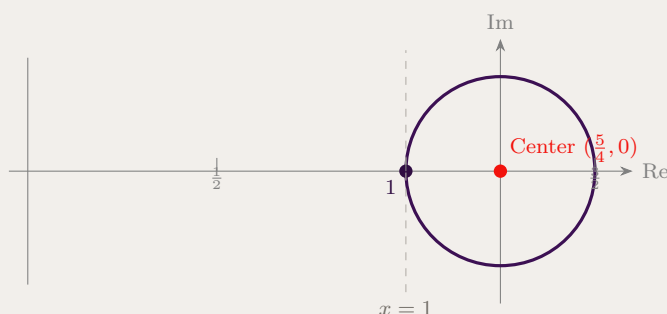
If z is a complex number, describe the locus defined by $\Re\left(\frac{1}{z-1}\right) = 2$.

Hint: Write $z = x + iy$ and set $w = z - 1 = x - 1 + iy$. Compute $\Re\left(\frac{w}{1}\right)$ by multiplying numerator and denominator by $\bar{w}$, then complete the square to reveal the circle; note the locus must pass through $z = 1$.

Solution 3.25: Sketch

$$\Re\left(\frac{1}{z-1}\right) = \frac{x-1}{(x-1)^2 + y^2} = 2 \Rightarrow (x-1)^2 - \frac{1}{2}(x-1) + y^2 = 0$$

Completing the square gives $(x - \frac{5}{4})^2 + y^2 = (\frac{1}{4})^2$, a circle centered at $(\frac{5}{4}, 0)$ with radius $\frac{1}{4}$ that passes through $z = 1$ and is tangent to the line $x = 1$.



Takeaways 3.2

- Translating by 1 then inverting sends vertical lines to circles that pass through the translation point.
- $\Re\left(\frac{1}{z-a}\right) = k \neq 0$ traces a circle through $z = a$ with center shifted by $\frac{1}{2k}$ along the real axis from a .
- Here the circle has center $(\frac{5}{4}, 0)$, radius $\frac{1}{4}$, and is tangent to the line $x = 1$.

Problem 3.26: Modulus-Argument Division

Given $\frac{1+\sqrt{3}i}{1+i} = \frac{1+\sqrt{3}}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{3}-1}{2}i$, express $\frac{1+i\sqrt{3}}{1+i}$ in modulus-argument form by converting both numerator and denominator.

Hint: $|1+i\sqrt{3}| = 2$, $\arg(1+i\sqrt{3}) = \pi/3$; $|1+i| = \sqrt{2}$, $\arg(1+i) = \pi/4$.

Solution 3.26: Sketch

$$\frac{1+i\sqrt{3}}{1+i} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{2}} \left(\cos\left(\frac{\pi}{3} - \frac{\pi}{4}\right) + i \sin\left(\frac{\pi}{3} - \frac{\pi}{4}\right) \right) = \sqrt{2} \left(\cos \frac{\pi}{12} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{12} \right).$$

Problem 3.27: Power in Polar Form

Let $\beta = 1 - i\sqrt{3}$. Express β^5 in modulus-argument form.

Hint: $|\beta| = 2$, $\arg(\beta) = -\pi/3$.

Solution 3.27: Sketch

$\beta = 2(\cos(-\pi/3) + i\sin(-\pi/3))$. Then $\beta^5 = 32(\cos(-5\pi/3) + i\sin(-5\pi/3)) = 32(\cos(\pi/3) + i\sin(\pi/3))$.

Problem 3.28: Deriving Trigonometric Value

Find the exact value of $\sin \frac{\pi}{12}$ using the angle subtraction formula. Note that $\frac{\pi}{12} = \frac{\pi}{3} - \frac{\pi}{4} = 60^\circ - 45^\circ = 15^\circ$.

$$\begin{aligned} \bullet \sin \frac{\pi}{4} &= \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}, \cos \frac{\pi}{4} = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \\ \bullet \sin \frac{\pi}{3} &= \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}, \cos \frac{\pi}{3} = \frac{1}{2} \end{aligned}$$

Hint: Use the angle subtraction formula: $\sin(A - B) = \sin A \cos B - \cos A \sin B$. Recall the exact values:

Solution 3.28: Sketch

We use the fact that $\frac{\pi}{12} = \frac{\pi}{3} - \frac{\pi}{4}$.

Applying the angle subtraction formula:

$$\begin{aligned} \sin \frac{\pi}{12} &= \sin \left(\frac{\pi}{3} - \frac{\pi}{4} \right) \\ &= \sin \frac{\pi}{3} \cos \frac{\pi}{4} - \cos \frac{\pi}{3} \sin \frac{\pi}{4} \\ &= \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} - \frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \\ &= \frac{\sqrt{6}}{4} - \frac{\sqrt{2}}{4} \\ &= \frac{\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{2}}{4} \end{aligned}$$

Alternative approach using complex numbers:

Consider the division $\frac{1+i\sqrt{3}}{1+i}$. In modulus-argument form:

- Numerator: $|1 + i\sqrt{3}| = 2$, $\arg(1 + i\sqrt{3}) = \frac{\pi}{3}$
- Denominator: $|1 + i| = \sqrt{2}$, $\arg(1 + i) = \frac{\pi}{4}$

Therefore:

$$\frac{1 + i\sqrt{3}}{1 + i} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{2}} \left(\cos \left(\frac{\pi}{3} - \frac{\pi}{4} \right) + i \sin \left(\frac{\pi}{3} - \frac{\pi}{4} \right) \right) = \sqrt{2} \left(\cos \frac{\pi}{12} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{12} \right)$$

Computing the division algebraically:

$$\frac{1 + i\sqrt{3}}{1 + i} = \frac{(1 + i\sqrt{3})(1 - i)}{(1 + i)(1 - i)} = \frac{1 - i + i\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{3}}{2} = \frac{1 + \sqrt{3}}{2} + i \frac{\sqrt{3} - 1}{2}$$

Comparing imaginary parts: $\sin \frac{\pi}{12} = \frac{\sqrt{3}-1}{2\sqrt{2}} = \frac{\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2}}{4}$.

Answer: $\sin \frac{\pi}{12} = \frac{\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2}}{4}$

Problem 3.29: Marking Rotated Point

A point P represents the complex number $z = 3 + 2i$ on the Argand diagram. Mark the point R representing $R = iz$.

Hint: Multiply by i rotates 90° counterclockwise. If $z = a + bi$, then $iz = i(a + bi) = (iq + v)i = -b + ai$.

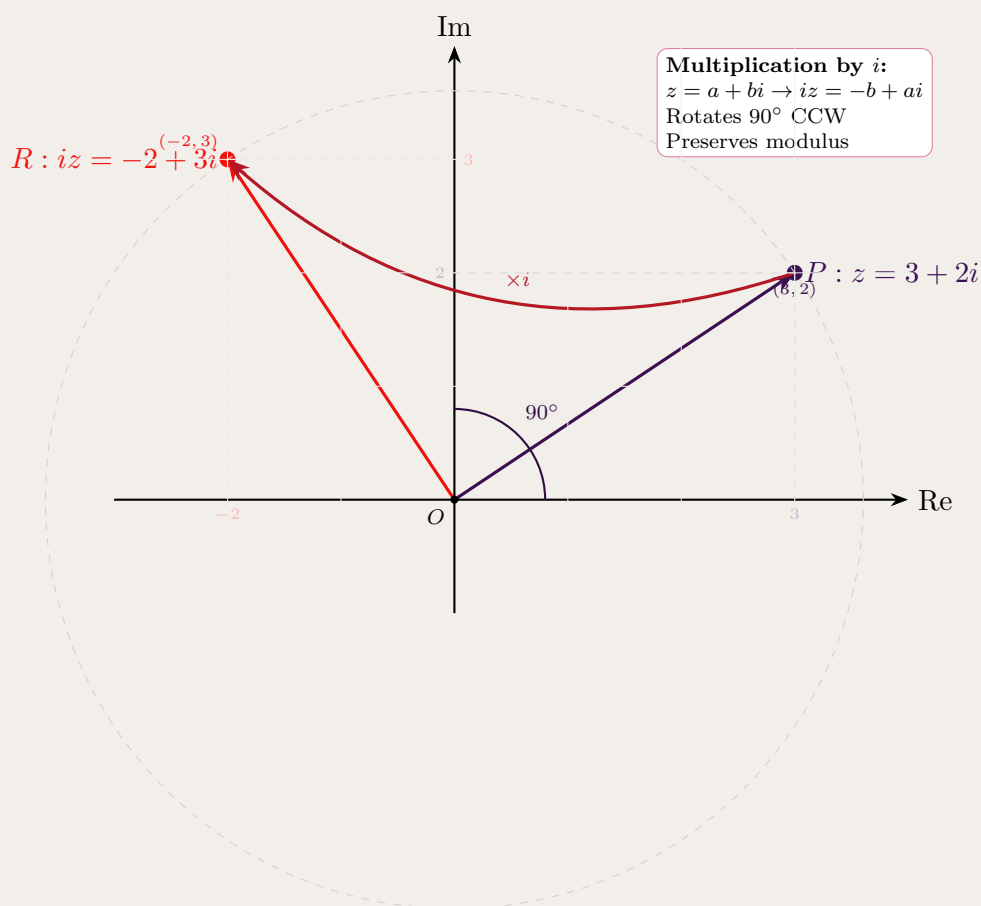
Solution 3.29: Sketch

If z is at (a, b) , then iz is at $(-b, a)$. Draw accordingly.

For $z = 3 + 2i$ at point $(3, 2)$:

$$iz = i(3 + 2i) = 3i + 2i^2 = 3i - 2 = -2 + 3i$$

So R is at $(-2, 3)$.



Key observation: Multiplying by i rotates any complex number by 90° counterclockwise while keeping the same distance from the origin.

Problem 3.30: Conjugate Root Property

$2 + i$ is a root of $P(z) = z^3 + rz^2 + sz + 20$ where r, s are real. State why $2 - i$ is also a root.

Hint: Polynomials with real coefficients have complex roots in conjugate pairs.

Solution 3.30: Sketch

Since $P(z)$ has real coefficients, if $2 + i$ is a root, then $\overline{2 + i} = 2 - i$ must also be a root.

Problem 3.31: Factorizing Over Reals

Factorise $P(z) = z^3 + rz^2 + sz + 20$ over the real numbers, given roots $2 + i$ and $2 - i$.

Hint: $(z - (2 + i))(z - (2 - i)) = (z - 2 - i)(z - 2 + i) = (z - 2)^2 - i^2 = z^2 - 4z + 5$.

Solution 3.31: Sketch

$(z - 2 - i)(z - 2 + i) = z^2 - 4z + 5$. Divide $P(z)$ by $z^2 - 4z + 5$ to find the third factor. $P(z) = (z^2 - 4z + 5)(z + 4)$ after polynomial division.

Problem 3.32: Vector Addition Point

Points P and Q represent the complex numbers $z = 2 + i$ and $w = 1 + 3i$ respectively on the Argand diagram. Mark point T representing $T = z + w$.

Hint: Use parallelogram law: T is the fourth vertex of parallelogram $OPTQ$ where O is the origin.

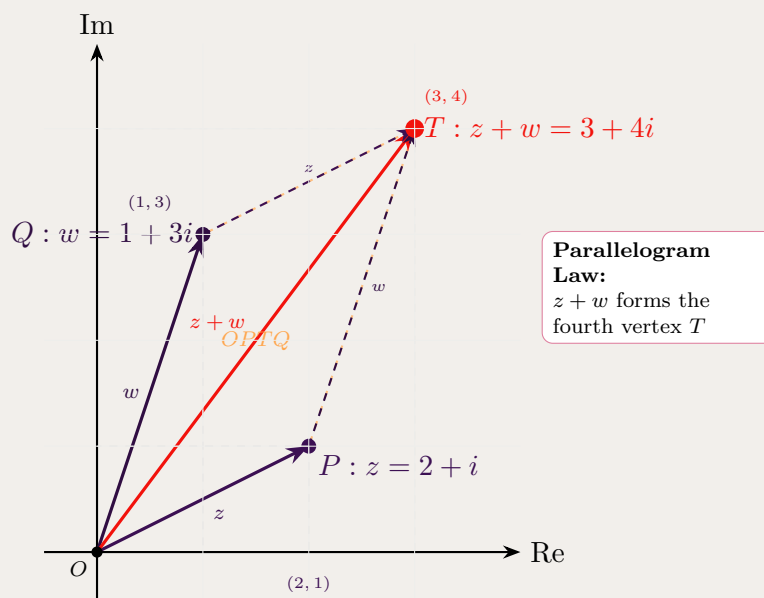
Solution 3.32: Sketch

From O to P is vector z , from O to Q is vector w . The sum $z + w$ is at the opposite corner of the parallelogram.

For $z = 2 + i$ and $w = 1 + 3i$:

$$z + w = (2 + i) + (1 + 3i) = 3 + 4i$$

So T is at $(3, 4)$.

**Key observations:**

- The parallelogram $OPTQ$ has OP parallel to QT (both represent vector z)
- Similarly, OQ is parallel to PT (both represent vector w)
- Vector addition: starting from O , go to P (add z), then to T (add w)
- Alternatively: starting from O , go to Q (add w), then to T (add z)
- The diagonal OT represents the sum $z + w$

Problem 3.33: Sum in Polar Form

Let $z = -2 - 2i$ and $w = 3 + i$. Express $z + w$ in modulus-argument form.

Hint: First find $z + w = 1 - i$, then convert to polar.

Solution 3.33: Sketch

$z + w = 1 - i$. $|z + w| = \sqrt{2}$, $\arg(z + w) = -\pi/4$. So $z + w = \sqrt{2}(\cos(-\pi/4) + i \sin(-\pi/4))$.

Problem 3.34: Division in Mixed Form

Express $\frac{z}{w}$ in form $x + iy$ where $z = -2 - 2i$, $w = 3 + i$.

$$\cdot \frac{(i-3)(i+3)}{(-2-2i)(3-i)} = \frac{i+3}{-2-2i} \text{Hint:}$$

Solution 3.34: Sketch

$$\frac{(-2-2i)(3-i)}{10} = \frac{-6+2i-6i+2i^2}{10} = \frac{-8-4i}{10} = -\frac{4}{5} - \frac{2}{5}i.$$

Problem 3.35: Sketching with Argument and Circle

Sketch the region: $-\frac{\pi}{4} \leq \arg z \leq 0$ and $|z - (1 - i)| \leq 1$.

Hint: The first is a wedge in the fourth quadrant. The second is a disk centered at $(1, -1)$.

Solution 3.35: Sketch

Draw rays at angles -45° and 0° from origin. Draw circle centered at $(1, -1)$ radius 1. Shade intersection.

Problem 3.36: High Power via De Moivre

Express z^9 in form $x + iy$ for $z = \sqrt{3} - i$.

$$\text{Hint: } z = 2(\cos(-\pi/6) + i \sin(-\pi/6)).$$

Solution 3.36: Sketch

$$z^9 = 2^9(\cos(-3\pi/2) + i \sin(-3\pi/2)) = 512(0 + i) = 512i.$$

Problem 3.37: Polar Form of Specific Number

Write $z = -1 + i\sqrt{3}$ in modulus-argument form.

Hint: $|z| = 2$, z is in the second quadrant with reference angle $\pi/3$.

Solution 3.37: Sketch

$$z = 2(\cos(2\pi/3) + i \sin(2\pi/3)).$$

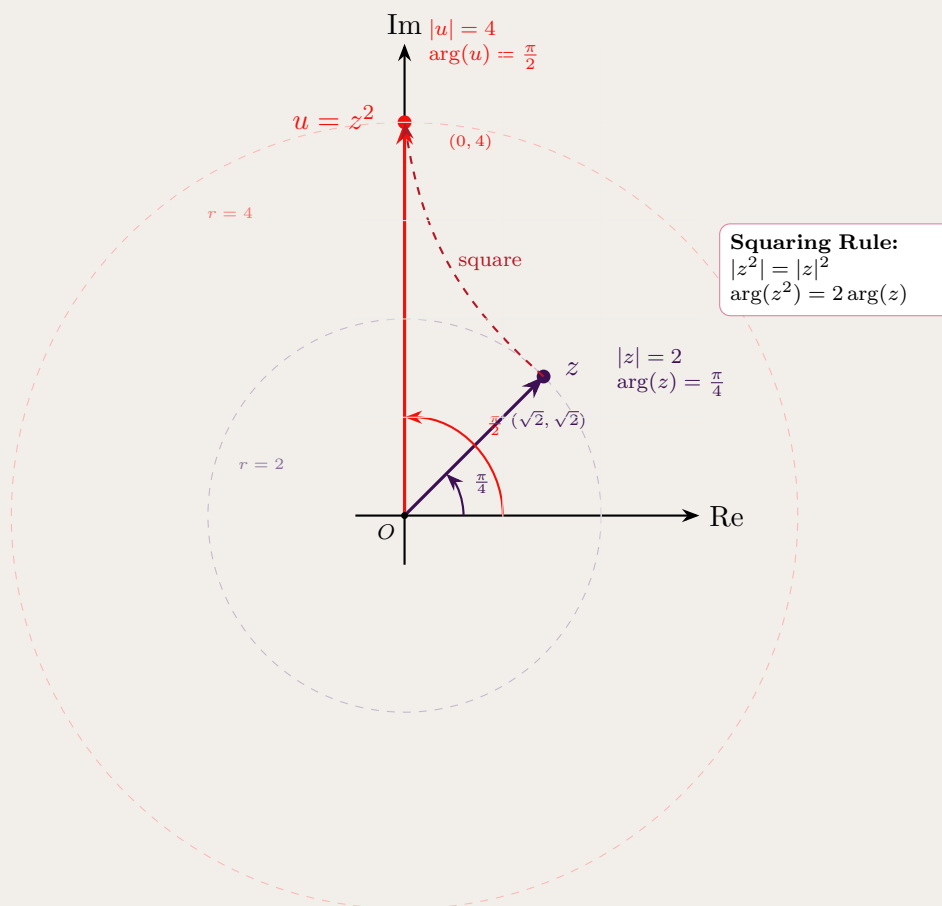
Problem 3.38: Plotting a Squared Number

Given $|z| = 2$, $\arg(z) = \frac{\pi}{4}$, plot $u = z^2$.

$$|z|^n = |z^n|, \arg(z^n) = n \arg(z) \pmod{2\pi}$$

Solution 3.38: Sketch

u has modulus 4 and argument $\pi/2$, so $u = 4i$. Plot at $(0, 4)$.

**Problem 3.39: Fifth Roots of Unity and Cosine Sum**

Let ω be a non-real root of $z^5 = 1$

a) Show that: $1 + \omega + \omega^2 + \omega^3 + \omega^4 = 0$

b) Hence, show that: $\cos\left(\frac{2\pi}{5}\right) + \cos\left(\frac{4\pi}{5}\right) = -\frac{1}{2}$

Hint: For part (a): The fifth roots of unity are roots of $z^5 - 1 = 0$. Factor as $(z - 1)(z^4 + z^3 + z^2 + z + 1) = 0$. For part (b): Use $\omega = e^{i2\pi/5}$ and $\omega^4 = e^{i8\pi/5} = e^{-i2\pi/5} = \bar{\omega}$. Add $\omega + \omega^4$ using Euler's formula.

Solution 3.39: Sketch

(a) Since $\omega^5 = 1$, factor $z^5 - 1 = (z - 1)(z^4 + z^3 + z^2 + z + 1) = 0$. As $\omega \neq 1$ (non-real), we have $z^4 + z^3 + z^2 + z + 1 = 0$, so $1 + \omega + \omega^2 + \omega^3 + \omega^4 = 0$. $\square$

(b) Let $\omega = e^{i2\pi/5}$. Then $\omega^4 = e^{-i2\pi/5} = \bar{\omega}$ and $\omega^3 = \bar{\omega}^2$. From (a):

$$1 + (\omega + \omega^4) + (\omega^2 + \omega^3) = 0 \implies 1 + 2\cos\frac{2\pi}{5} + 2\cos\frac{4\pi}{5} = 0$$

Therefore $\cos\frac{2\pi}{5} + \cos\frac{4\pi}{5} = -\frac{1}{2}$. $\square$

Problem 3.40: Cube Roots of Unity Properties

If ω is a complex cube root of unity, show that:

a) $1 + \omega + \omega^2 = 0$

b) $1 + \omega + \bar{\omega} = 0$

c) $(6\omega + 1)(6\omega^2 + 1) = 31$

d) $(1 + \omega^2)^3(2 + 3\omega + 3\omega^2) = 1$

Hint: A complex cube root of unity satisfies $\omega^3 = 1$ and $\omega \neq 1$. Use $\omega = e^{i2\pi/3}$ and the fundamental identity $1 + \omega + \omega^2 = 0$ to prove all parts. For (b), note that $\omega^2 = \bar{\omega}$. For (c) and (d), expand and repeatedly substitute $\omega^3 = 1$ and $1 + \omega + \omega^2 = 0$.

Solution 3.40: Sketch

Key facts: A complex cube root of unity ω satisfies:

- $\omega^3 = 1$
- $\omega = e^{i2\pi/3} = -\frac{1}{2} + i\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$
- $\omega^2 = e^{i4\pi/3} = -\frac{1}{2} - i\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$
- $\omega^2 = \bar{\omega}$ (conjugates)

Part (a): Show $1 + \omega + \omega^2 = 0$

Since ω is a cube root of unity: $\omega^3 = 1$, so $\omega^3 - 1 = 0$.

Factor: $(\omega - 1)(\omega^2 + \omega + 1) = 0$

Since $\omega \neq 1$ (it's a complex root), we must have:

$$\omega^2 + \omega + 1 = 0$$

Therefore: $1 + \omega + \omega^2 = 0$ $\square$

Part (b): Show $1 + \omega + \bar{\omega} = 0$

Since $\omega = e^{i2\pi/3}$ and $\omega^2 = e^{i4\pi/3} = e^{-i2\pi/3}$, we have:

$$\omega^2 = \bar{\omega}$$

From part (a): $1 + \omega + \omega^2 = 0$

Substituting $\omega^2 = \bar{\omega}$:

$$1 + \omega + \bar{\omega} = 0 \quad \square$$

Part (c): Show $(6\omega + 1)(6\omega^2 + 1) = 31$

Expand the product:

$$\begin{aligned} (6\omega + 1)(6\omega^2 + 1) &= 36\omega \cdot \omega^2 + 6\omega + 6\omega^2 + 1 \\ &= 36\omega^3 + 6\omega + 6\omega^2 + 1 \end{aligned}$$

Use $\omega^3 = 1$:

$$= 36(1) + 6\omega + 6\omega^2 + 1 = 36 + 1 + 6(\omega + \omega^2)$$

From part (a): $\omega + \omega^2 = -1$

Therefore:

$$= 37 + 6(-1) = 37 - 6 = 31 \quad \square$$

Part (d): From (a), $1 + \omega^2 = -\omega$, so $(1 + \omega^2)^3 = (-\omega)^3 = -\omega^3 = -1$. Also, $2 + 3\omega + 3\omega^2 = 2 + 3(-1) = -1$. Therefore $(1 + \omega^2)^3(2 + 3\omega + 3\omega^2) = (-1)(-1) = 1$. $\square$

Problem 3.41: Circle Locus in Complex Plane

Show that the following relationship geometrically describes a circle in the complex plane:

$$\frac{1}{z} - \frac{1}{\bar{z}} = i$$

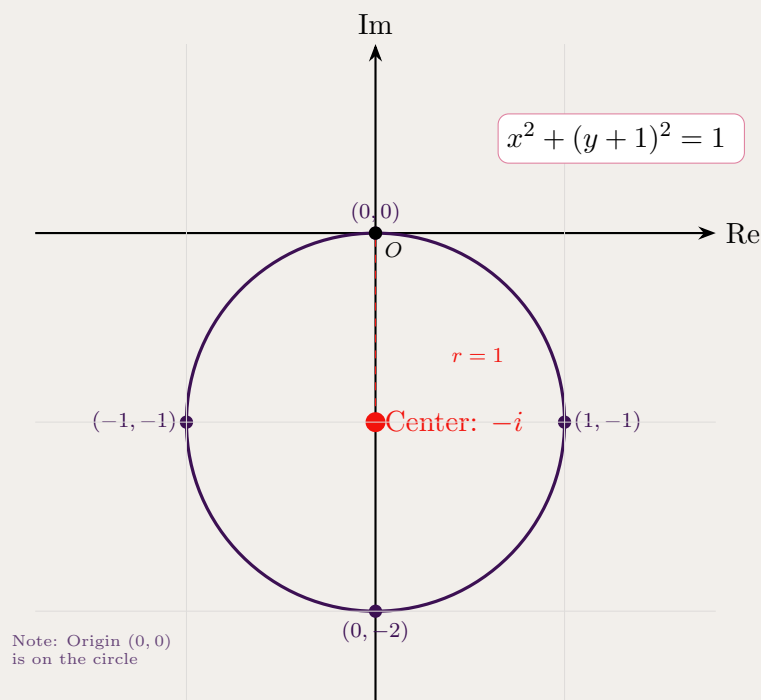
Hint: Let $z = x + iy$ where $x, y \in \mathbb{R}$. Express $\frac{z}{1}$ and $\frac{\bar{z}}{1}$ in terms of x and y , then separate real and imaginary parts. The result should be an equation of the form $(x - a)^2 + (y - b)^2 = r^2$.

Solution 3.41: Sketch

Let $z = x + iy$. Then:

$$\frac{1}{z} - \frac{1}{\bar{z}} = \frac{x - iy}{x^2 + y^2} - \frac{x + iy}{x^2 + y^2} = \frac{-2iy}{x^2 + y^2}$$

Given this equals i : $\frac{-2iy}{x^2 + y^2} = 1 \Rightarrow x^2 + y^2 + 2y = 0 \Rightarrow x^2 + (y + 1)^2 = 1$. This is a circle centered at $-i$ with radius 1.



Verification: The origin $(0,0)$ satisfies the equation: $0^2 + (0 + 1)^2 = 1$ ✓

Geometric interpretation: For any point z on this circle, the difference $\frac{1}{z} - \frac{1}{\bar{z}}$ equals i . This relates the reciprocals and their conjugates in a specific way that constrains z to lie on a circle.

Problem 3.42: Square OABC with Complex Numbers

$OABC$ is a square with point A represented by the complex number $z = 2 + i$.

- Let w represent the complex number at point C . Prove that: $z^2 + w^2 = 0$
- Find the complex numbers represented by B and C .
- Find the complex number represented by the vector $\overrightarrow{AC}$

Hint: For a square $OABC$ with O at the origin, C is obtained by rotating A by 90° counterclockwise, so $w = iz$. For part (a), substitute and use $i^2 = -1$. For part (b), B is the fourth vertex, obtained by $B = A + C$ (vector addition).

Solution 3.42: Sketch

Given: Square $OABC$ with O at origin and A at $z = 2 + i$.

Part (a): Prove $z^2 + w^2 = 0$

For a square with one vertex at the origin O and adjacent vertex at A (represented by z), the next vertex C (going counterclockwise) is obtained by rotating OA by 90° counterclockwise.

Rotation by 90° is achieved by multiplying by i :

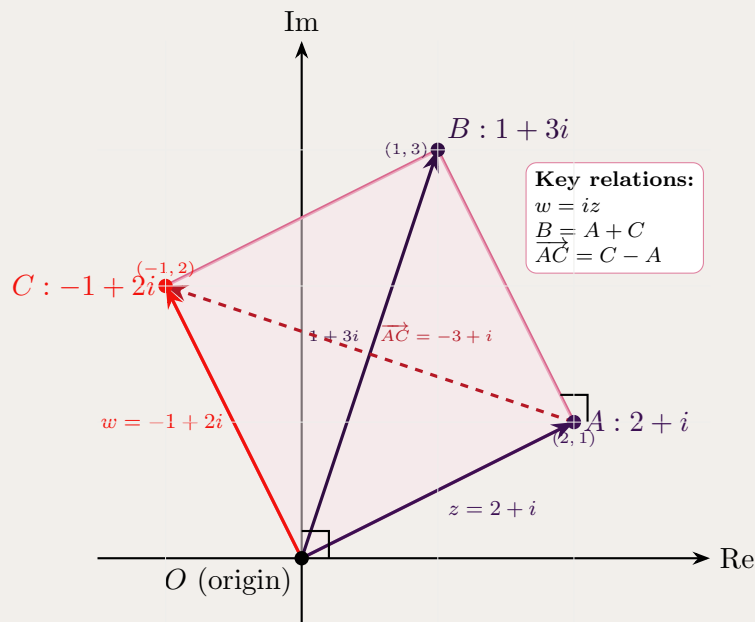
$$w = iz$$

Now calculate $z^2 + w^2$:

$$\begin{aligned} z^2 + w^2 &= z^2 + (iz)^2 \\ &= z^2 + i^2 z^2 \\ &= z^2 + (-1)z^2 \\ &= z^2 - z^2 \\ &= 0 \quad \square \end{aligned}$$

(b) C : $w = iz = i(2 + i) = 2i - 1 = -1 + 2i$. B : $B = A + C = (2 + i) + (-1 + 2i) = 1 + 3i$.

(c) $\overrightarrow{AC} = C - A = (-1 + 2i) - (2 + i) = -3 + i$.

**Problem 3.43: Square ABCD Vertices with Complex Numbers**

$ABCD$ is a square in the complex plane. The vertices A and B represent the complex numbers $9 + i$ and $4 + 13i$ respectively. Find the complex numbers corresponding to vertices C and D .

Hint: The vector from A to B is $\overrightarrow{AB} = B - A = (4 + 13i) - (9 + i) = -5 + 12i$. To find C , rotate $\overrightarrow{AB}$ by 90° counterclockwise (multiply by i) and add to B . Similarly for D .

Solution 3.43: Sketch

$\overrightarrow{AB} = B - A = (4 + 13i) - (9 + i) = -5 + 12i$. Rotate by 90° : $\overrightarrow{BC} = i(-5 + 12i) = -12 - 5i$. Thus $C = B + \overrightarrow{BC} = (4 + 13i) + (-12 - 5i) = -8 + 8i$. Similarly, $D = A + \overrightarrow{BC} = (9 + i) + (-12 - 5i) = -3 - 4i$.

Answers: $C = -8 + 8i$, $D = -3 - 4i$.

Problem 3.44: Square ABCD Vector Relationship

The points A, B, C and D on the Argand diagram represent the complex numbers a, b, c and d respectively. The points form a square $ABCD$.

By using vectors, or otherwise, show that $c = (1 + i)d - ia$.

Hint: Use the fact that in a square, consecutive sides are equal in length and perpendicular. The key relationship is $\overrightarrow{DC} = i \cdot \overrightarrow{AD}$ (rotation by 90°).

Solution 3.44: Proof

In square $ABCD$, $\overrightarrow{DC} = i \cdot \overrightarrow{AD}$ (rotation by 90°). Thus:

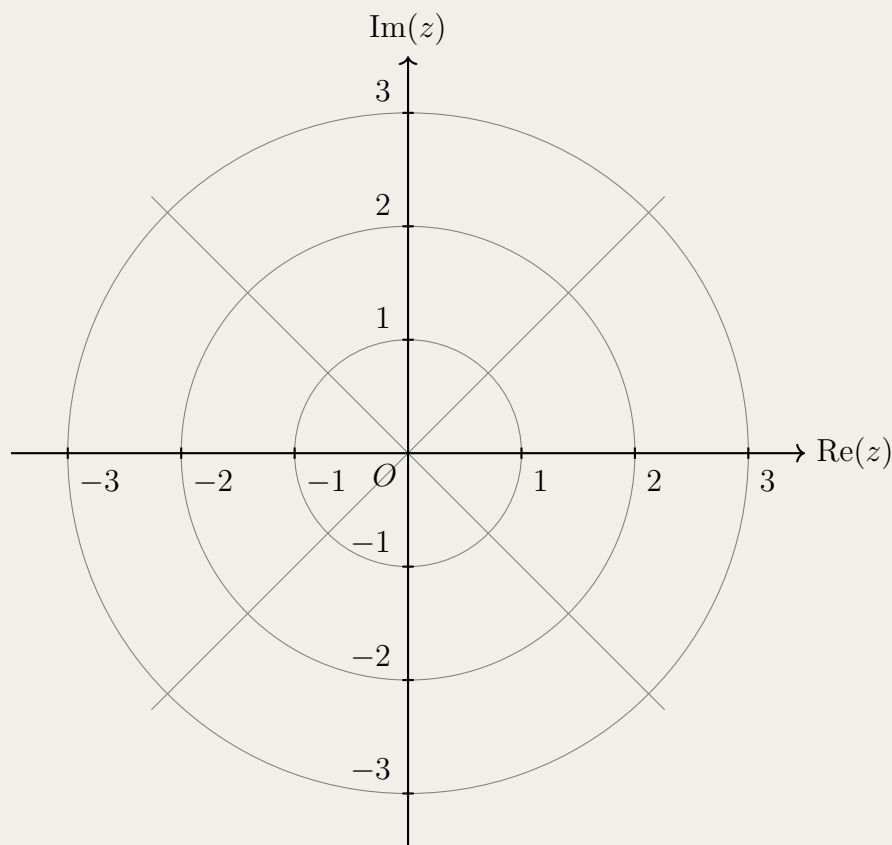
$$c - d = i(d - a) = id - ia \implies c = d + id - ia = (1 + i)d - ia \quad \square$$

Problem 3.45: Region with Modulus and Argument Constraints

Sketch the region in the Argand plane defined by the set:

$$S = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : 1 \leq z\bar{z} \leq 9\} \cap \left\{z \in \mathbb{C} : \frac{\pi}{4} \leq \arg(z) \leq \frac{3\pi}{4}\right\}$$

(Use the polar grid scaffold below to draw your solution).



- Hint:**
- **Hint 1:** Recall the fundamental identity $z\bar{z} = |z|^2$. What geometric shape does the boundary $|z|^2 = r^2$ represent?
 - **Hint 2:** The inequality $1 \leq |z|^2 \leq 9$ forms an annulus (a ring). Determine its inner and outer radii.
 - **Hint 3:** The condition $\frac{\pi}{4} \leq \arg(z) \leq \frac{3\pi}{4}$ restricts the region to a specific sector.
 - **Hint 4:** Pay attention to the inequality symbols ($\leq$). Boundary lines should be solid.

Solution 3.45: Sketch

1. Analyze the Modulus Condition:

Using $z\bar{z} = |z|^2$, the first condition becomes:

$$1 \leq |z|^2 \leq 9 \implies 1 \leq |z| \leq 3$$

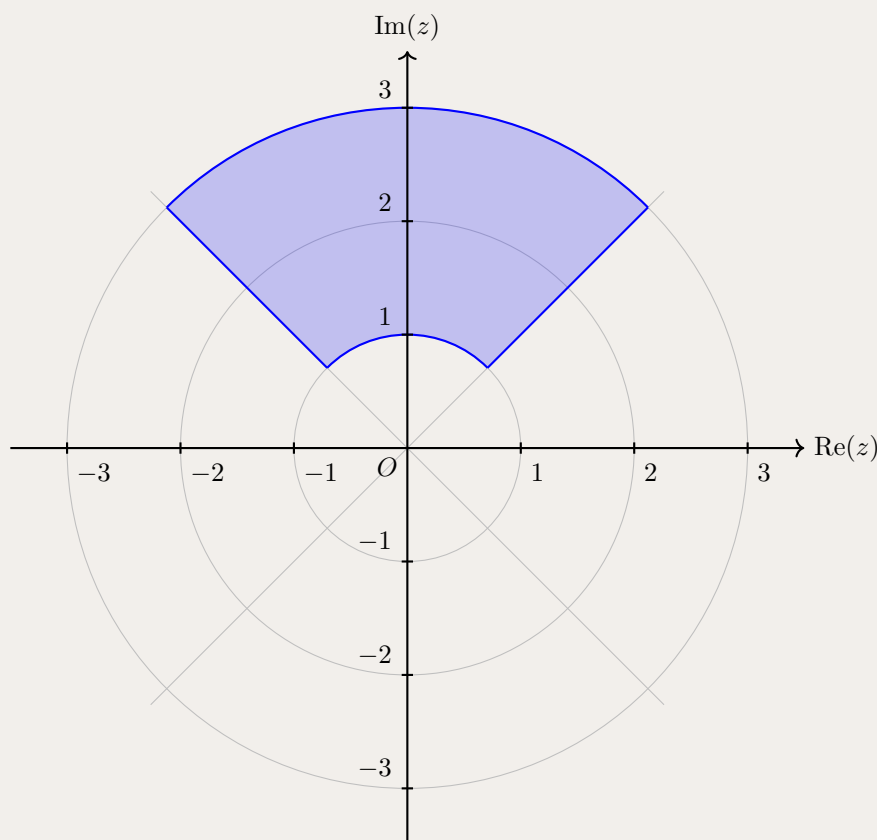
Geometrically, this represents the closed annulus lying between the circles of radius 1 and 3 centered at the origin.

2. Analyze the Argument Condition:

The condition $\frac{\pi}{4} \leq \arg(z) \leq \frac{3\pi}{4}$ describes a sector swept between the ray at 45° ($\frac{\pi}{4}$) and the ray at 135° ($\frac{3\pi}{4}$).

3. Combine and Sketch:

The set S is the intersection ($\cap$) of these two conditions. We shade the portion of the annulus trapped between the two rays. Because all inequalities are inclusive ($\leq$), all boundary curves are solid.



Takeaways 3.3

- **The Modulus-Conjugate Bridge:** The identity $z\bar{z} = |z|^2$ is an essential tool.
- **Polar Thinking:** When a problem involves $z\bar{z}$ and $\arg(z)$, thinking in polar coordinates (r, θ) makes the sketch significantly easier.
- **Intersection of Loci:** When dealing with sets intersecting $(\cap)$, sketch boundaries lightly first, then boldly outline and shade the overlapping region.

3.3 Advanced Complex Numbers Problems**Problem 3.46: Complex Region with Exclusion**

Sketch the region on the Argand diagram where $|z - \bar{z}| < 2$ and $|z - 1| \geq 1$ hold simultaneously.

Hint: $|z - \bar{z}| = 2|y|$, so the first inequality gives $|y| < 1$. The second is the exterior of a circle.

Solution 3.46: Sketch

The region $|y| < 1$ is a horizontal strip $-1 < y < 1$. The region $|z - 1| \geq 1$ is outside the circle centered at $(1, 0)$ with radius 1. Shade the intersection: horizontal strip with circular hole.

Problem 3.47: Isosceles Right Triangle

Triangle ABC is represented by z_1, z_2, z_3 . It is isosceles and right-angled at B . Explain why $(z_1 - z_2)^2 = -(z_3 - z_2)^2$.

Hint: The vectors BA and BC are perpendicular and equal in length. Multiplication by i rotates by 90° .

Solution 3.47: Sketch

$BA = z_1 - z_2$, $BC = z_3 - z_2$. Since $BA \perp BC$ and $|BA| = |BC|$, we have $BA = \pm i \cdot BC$. Squaring: $(z_1 - z_2)^2 = (\pm i)^2 (z_3 - z_2)^2 = -1 \cdot (z_3 - z_2)^2$.

Problem 3.48: Square from Triangle

Three vertices of a square $ABCD$ in the complex plane are represented by complex numbers z_1 (point A), z_2 (point B), and z_3 (point C). Given that consecutive sides of a square are perpendicular and equal in length, find the complex number z_4 representing vertex D in terms of z_1, z_2, z_3 .

Hint: Since $ABCD$ is a square, side AB is perpendicular to side BC , and $|AB| = |BC|$. This means $BA = i \cdot BC$ (or $-i \cdot BC$). Use the same relationship for sides CD and DA .

Solution 3.48: Sketch

For a square $ABCD$, consecutive sides are equal in length and perpendicular.

The vector from B to A is $z_1 - z_2$, and from B to C is $z_3 - z_2$.

Since $BA \perp BC$ and $|BA| = |BC|$, we have:

$$z_1 - z_2 = i(z_3 - z_2) \quad (\text{rotating } BC \text{ by } 90^\circ \text{ counterclockwise})$$

Similarly, for the square to close, the vector from C to D must equal the vector from B to C rotated 90° :

$$z_4 - z_3 = i(z_2 - z_3)$$

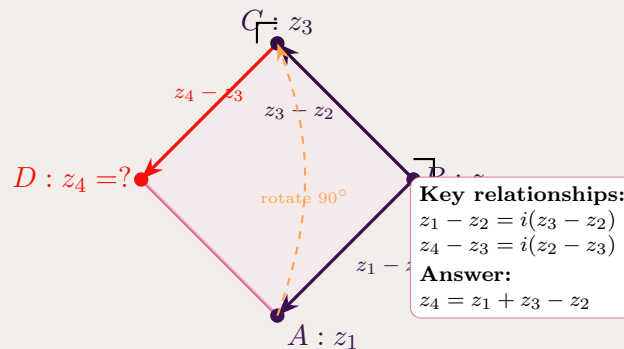
Solving for z_4 :

$$\begin{aligned} z_4 &= z_3 + i(z_2 - z_3) \\ &= z_3 + iz_2 - iz_3 \\ &= z_2 \cdot i + z_3(1 - i) \\ &= iz_2 + z_3(1 - i) \end{aligned}$$

Alternative formula: Using the parallelogram property, we can also write:

$$z_4 = z_1 + z_3 - z_2$$

This works because $\vec{AD} = \vec{BC}$, so $z_4 - z_1 = z_3 - z_2$.



Verification: Both formulas are equivalent:

$$\begin{aligned} iz_2 + z_3(1 - i) &= iz_2 + z_3 - iz_3 \\ &= z_3 + i(z_2 - z_3) \end{aligned}$$

And using $z_1 - z_2 = i(z_3 - z_2)$, we get $z_1 = z_2 + i(z_3 - z_2) = iz_3 + z_2(1 - i)$.

Therefore: $z_4 = z_1 + z_3 - z_2$

Problem 3.49: Factoring Polynomial

Express $P(x) = x^4 - 12x^3 + 59x^2 - 138x + 130$ as product of quadratic factors, given roots $3 + i$ and $3 + 2i$.

Hint: The roots are $3 \pm i$ and $3 \pm 2i$. Group conjugate pairs.

Solution 3.49: Sketch

$(x - (3 + i))(x - (3 - i)) = (x - 3)^2 + 1 = x^2 - 6x + 10$. $(x - (3 + 2i))(x - (3 - 2i)) = (x - 3)^2 + 4 = x^2 - 6x + 13$.
Thus $P(x) = (x^2 - 6x + 10)(x^2 - 6x + 13)$.

Problem 3.50: Real Root Count

Deduce that $x^4 - 3x^3 + 5x^2 + 7x - 8 = 0$ has exactly two real roots.

Hint: A degree-4 polynomial with real coefficients has either 0, 2, or 4 real roots. Check behavior or use Descartes' rule.

Solution 3.50: Sketch

Complex roots come in conjugate pairs. If there are 4 complex roots, they form 2 pairs, leaving 0 real roots. If 1 pair of complex roots, then 2 real roots. Since the polynomial has sign changes, it must have at least one positive real root. Testing values or using intermediate value theorem confirms exactly 2 real roots.

Problem 3.51: Vector Addition and Angles

Consider a sequence of unit complex numbers defined by:

$$z_n = \cos(\alpha + n\beta) + i \sin(\alpha + n\beta) = e^{i(\alpha + n\beta)}$$

for $n = 0, 1, 2, 3, \dots$

On the Argand diagram, we construct points by cumulative vector addition:

$$P_0 = z_0$$

$$P_1 = z_0 + z_1$$

$$P_2 = z_0 + z_1 + z_2$$

$$P_3 = z_0 + z_1 + z_2 + z_3$$

$$\vdots$$

These points form a polygonal path. Using vector addition, prove that all external angles of this polygon are equal to β . That is, show that $\theta_0 = \theta_1 = \theta_2 = \dots = \beta$, where θ_n is the external angle at vertex P_n .

Hint: Each z_n is a unit vector at angle $\alpha + n\beta$. The angle between consecutive vectors is constant. The external angle is the amount the direction turns from one segment to the next.

Solution 3.51: Sketch**Understanding the geometry:**

The polygonal path is formed by placing unit vectors $z_0, z_1, z_2, \dots$ tip-to-tail. Each vector z_n is a unit complex number (lies on the unit circle) with argument $\alpha + n\beta$.

Step 1: Arguments of consecutive vectors

For any consecutive pair of vectors:

$$\begin{aligned}\arg(z_n) &= \alpha + n\beta \\ \arg(z_{n+1}) &= \alpha + (n+1)\beta = \alpha + n\beta + \beta\end{aligned}$$

The difference in arguments is:

$$\arg(z_{n+1}) - \arg(z_n) = \beta$$

Step 2: Geometric interpretation

The segment from P_n to P_{n+1} is represented by the vector z_{n+1} (pointing in direction $\arg(z_{n+1})$).

The segment from P_{n-1} to P_n is represented by the vector z_n (pointing in direction $\arg(z_n)$).

The external angle θ_n at vertex P_n is the angle by which the path turns. This is precisely the difference in the directions of consecutive vectors:

$$\theta_n = \arg(z_{n+1}) - \arg(z_n) = \beta$$

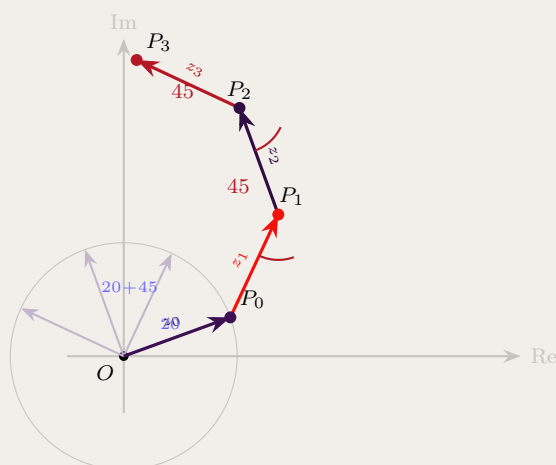
Step 3: Conclusion

Since this difference is constant for all n , we have:

$$\theta_0 = \theta_1 = \theta_2 = \dots = \beta$$

All external angles equal β , which means the polygon turns by the same angle at each vertex.

Special case: If $\beta = \frac{2\pi}{n}$, the path closes after n steps, forming a regular n -sided polygon.



The diagram shows unit vectors z_0, z_1, z_2, z_3 (shown faintly from origin) being added tip-to-tail to form the polygonal path $P_0 \rightarrow P_1 \rightarrow P_2 \rightarrow P_3$. Each turn angle (external angle) is $\beta = 45^\circ$.

Problem 3.52: Modulus via Trigonometry

Show $|z| = 2 \sin \theta$ for $z = 1 - \cos 2\theta + i \sin 2\theta$.

Hint: Use $1 - \cos 2\theta = 2 \sin^2 \theta$ and $\sin 2\theta = 2 \sin \theta \cos \theta$.

Solution 3.52: Sketch

$|z|^2 = (1 - \cos 2\theta)^2 + \sin^2 2\theta = (2 \sin^2 \theta)^2 + (2 \sin \theta \cos \theta)^2 = 4 \sin^4 \theta + 4 \sin^2 \theta \cos^2 \theta = 4 \sin^2 \theta (\sin^2 \theta + \cos^2 \theta) = 4 \sin^2 \theta$. Thus $|z| = 2 |\sin \theta|$.

Problem 3.53: Euler's Formula Identity

Show $e^{in\theta} + e^{-in\theta} = 2\cos(n\theta)$.

Hint: Use $e^{i\phi} = \cos\phi + i\sin\phi$.

Solution 3.53: Sketch

$e^{in\theta} = \cos(n\theta) + i\sin(n\theta)$ and $e^{-in\theta} = \cos(n\theta) - i\sin(n\theta)$. Adding: $e^{in\theta} + e^{-in\theta} = 2\cos(n\theta)$.

Problem 3.54: Modulus and Angle Calculation with Complex Exponentials

Let z be the complex number $z = e^{\frac{i\pi}{6}}$ and w be the complex number $w = e^{\frac{3i\pi}{4}}$.

(i) By first writing z and w in Cartesian form, or otherwise, show that

$$|z + w|^2 = \frac{4 - \sqrt{6} + \sqrt{2}}{2}.$$

(ii) The complex numbers z , w and $z + w$ are represented in the complex plane by the vectors $\vec{OA}$, $\vec{OB}$ and $\vec{OC}$ respectively, where O is the origin.

Show that $\angle AOC = \frac{7\pi}{24}$.

(iii) Deduce that $\cos \frac{7\pi}{24} = \frac{\sqrt{8 - 2\sqrt{6} + 2\sqrt{2}}}{4}$.

Hint: For (i): Convert to Cartesian form and compute $|z + w|^2 = x^2 + y^2$. For (ii): Since $|z| = |w| = 1$, the parallelogram $OACB$ is a rhombus, and the diagonal bisects the angle. For (iii): Use the relationship $|z + w| = 2\cos(\angle AOC)$ in a rhombus.

Solution 3.54: Full Solution**Part (i)**

First, we convert z and w to Cartesian form:

$$z = e^{\frac{i\pi}{6}} = \cos\left(\frac{\pi}{6}\right) + i \sin\left(\frac{\pi}{6}\right) = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} + \frac{1}{2}i$$

$$w = e^{\frac{3i\pi}{4}} = \cos\left(\frac{3\pi}{4}\right) + i \sin\left(\frac{3\pi}{4}\right) = -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}i = \frac{-\sqrt{2}}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}i$$

Now, find $z + w$:

$$z + w = \left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} - \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}\right) + i\left(\frac{1}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}\right) = \frac{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}}{2} + i\frac{1 + \sqrt{2}}{2}$$

Calculate the square of the modulus $|z + w|^2 = x^2 + y^2$:

$$\begin{aligned} |z + w|^2 &= \left(\frac{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}}{2}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{1 + \sqrt{2}}{2}\right)^2 \\ &= \frac{3 - 2\sqrt{6} + 2}{4} + \frac{1 + 2\sqrt{2} + 2}{4} \\ &= \frac{5 - 2\sqrt{6} + 3 + 2\sqrt{2}}{4} \\ &= \frac{8 - 2\sqrt{6} + 2\sqrt{2}}{4} \\ &= \frac{4 - \sqrt{6} + \sqrt{2}}{2} \quad \checkmark \end{aligned}$$

Part (ii)

Note that $|z| = |e^{\frac{i\pi}{6}}| = 1$ and $|w| = |e^{\frac{3i\pi}{4}}| = 1$. Since the moduli are equal ($OA = OB = 1$), the parallelogram $OACB$ formed by vector addition is a **rhombus**.

In a rhombus, the main diagonal $\overrightarrow{OC}$ bisects the angle between the adjacent sides $\overrightarrow{OA}$ and $\overrightarrow{OB}$.

Find $\angle AOB$:

$$\begin{aligned} \arg(z) &= \frac{\pi}{6} = \frac{4\pi}{24}, \quad \arg(w) = \frac{3\pi}{4} = \frac{18\pi}{24} \\ \angle AOB &= \arg(w) - \arg(z) = \frac{18\pi}{24} - \frac{4\pi}{24} = \frac{14\pi}{24} \end{aligned}$$

Since $\overrightarrow{OC}$ bisects $\angle AOB$, the angle between $\overrightarrow{OA}$ and $\overrightarrow{OC}$ is half of $\angle AOB$:

$$\angle AOC = \frac{1}{2} \times \frac{14\pi}{24} = \frac{7\pi}{24} \quad \checkmark$$

Part (iii)

We use the geometry of the rhombus. The length of the diagonal OC can be calculated using the property that in a rhombus with side length 1 and angle θ between the diagonal and the side:

$$OC = 2 \times OA \times \cos(\angle AOC)$$

Substituting the known values:

$$|z + w| = 2(1) \cos\left(\frac{7\pi}{24}\right) = 2 \cos\left(\frac{7\pi}{24}\right)$$

Squaring both sides:

$$|z + w|^2 = 4 \cos^2\left(\frac{7\pi}{24}\right)$$

Substitute the result from Part (i):

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{4 - \sqrt{6} + \sqrt{2}}{2} &= 4 \cos^2\left(\frac{7\pi}{24}\right) \\ \cos^2\left(\frac{7\pi}{24}\right) &= \frac{4 - \sqrt{6} + \sqrt{2}}{8} = \frac{8 - 2\sqrt{6} + 2\sqrt{2}}{16} \end{aligned}$$

Taking the square root (noting the angle is acute, so cosine is positive):

$$\cos\left(\frac{7\pi}{24}\right) = \sqrt{\frac{8 - 2\sqrt{6} + 2\sqrt{2}}{16}} = \frac{\sqrt{8 - 2\sqrt{6} + 2\sqrt{2}}}{4} \quad \checkmark$$

Problem 3.55: Equilateral Triangle

Let z_1 be a non-zero complex number represented by point A on the Argand diagram, and let $z_2 = e^{i\pi/3}z_1$ be represented by point B . The origin is represented by point O . Prove that triangle $\triangle OAB$ is equilateral.

Hint: Multiplication by $e^{i\pi/3}$ rotates z_1 by angle $\pi/3 = 60^\circ$ while preserving its modulus. Therefore $|z_1| = |z_2|$ and the angle $\angle AOB = \pi/3$.

Solution 3.55: Sketch

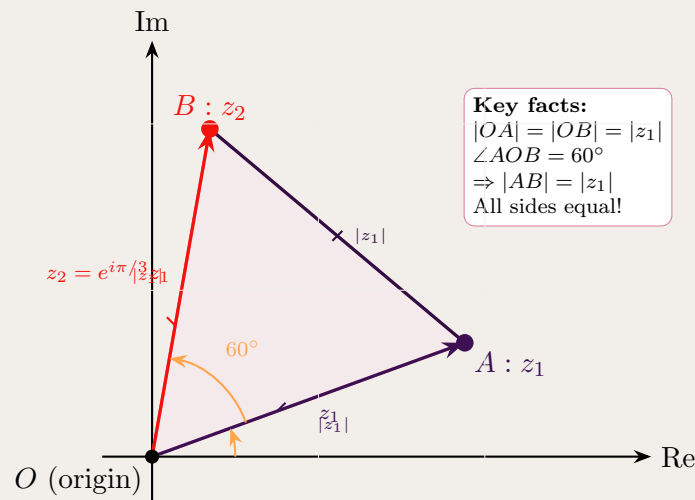
Given $z_2 = e^{i\pi/3}z_1$, we show all three sides of triangle OAB are equal.

Step 1: Since $|e^{i\pi/3}| = 1$, we have $|OA| = |z_1|$ and $|OB| = |z_2| = |e^{i\pi/3}z_1| = |z_1|$.

Step 2: Since $z_2 = e^{i\pi/3}z_1$, the angle $\angle AOB = \arg(z_2) - \arg(z_1) = \frac{\pi}{3} = 60^\circ$.

Step 3: By law of cosines: $|AB|^2 = |z_1|^2 + |z_1|^2 - 2|z_1|^2 \cos(\pi/3) = 2|z_1|^2 - |z_1|^2 = |z_1|^2$, so $|AB| = |z_1|$.

Conclusion: $|OA| = |OB| = |AB| = |z_1|$, so triangle OAB is equilateral.



Alternative: $|AB| = |z_2 - z_1| = |z_1||e^{i\pi/3} - 1| = |z_1| \cdot |(1/2 + i\sqrt{3}/2) - 1| = |z_1|\sqrt{1/4 + 3/4} = |z_1|$. $\square$

Problem 3.56: Algebraic Identity

Consider an equilateral triangle $\triangle OAB$ where O is the origin, A represents complex number z_1 , and B represents $z_2 = e^{i\pi/3}z_1$ (i.e., z_2 is obtained by rotating z_1 by 60°). Prove the algebraic identity:

$$z_1^2 + z_2^2 = z_1 z_2$$

Hint: Let $\omega = e^{i\pi/3}$, so $z_2 = \omega z_1$. Show that ω satisfies $\omega^2 - \omega + 1 = 0$ by using the fact that $\omega^3 = e^{i\pi} = -1$.

Solution 3.56: Sketch

Let $\omega = e^{i\pi/3}$ (a primitive 6th root of unity). Then $z_2 = \omega z_1$.

Left-hand side:

$$\begin{aligned} z_1^2 + z_2^2 &= z_1^2 + (\omega z_1)^2 \\ &= z_1^2 + \omega^2 z_1^2 \\ &= z_1^2(1 + \omega^2) \end{aligned}$$

Right-hand side:

$$\begin{aligned} z_1 z_2 &= z_1 \cdot \omega z_1 \\ &= \omega z_1^2 \end{aligned}$$

To prove: We need to show that $1 + \omega^2 = \omega$, or equivalently:

$$\omega^2 - \omega + 1 = 0$$

Key observation: Since $\omega = e^{i\pi/3}$, we have:

$$\omega^3 = e^{i\pi/3 \cdot 3} = e^{i\pi} = -1$$

Therefore:

$$\omega^3 + 1 = 0$$

This factors as:

$$(\omega + 1)(\omega^2 - \omega + 1) = 0$$

Since $\omega = e^{i\pi/3} = \cos 60^\circ + i \sin 60^\circ = \frac{1}{2} + i \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \neq -1$, we must have:

$$\omega^2 - \omega + 1 = 0$$

Therefore $1 + \omega^2 = \omega$, which gives us:

$$z_1^2(1 + \omega^2) = z_1^2 \cdot \omega = \omega z_1^2 = z_1 z_2$$

Thus: $z_1^2 + z_2^2 = z_1 z_2$ $\square$

Alternative direct verification: We can also verify by direct calculation:

$$\begin{aligned} \omega^2 &= e^{i2\pi/3} = \cos 120^\circ + i \sin 120^\circ = -\frac{1}{2} + i \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \\ 1 + \omega^2 &= 1 + \left(-\frac{1}{2} + i \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right) = \frac{1}{2} + i \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} = \omega \quad \checkmark \end{aligned}$$

Problem 3.57: Finding Non-Real Roots

Find the two complex roots of $P(x) = x^5 - 10x^2 + 15x - 6$.

Hint: Test for rational roots first (like $x = 1$). Factor out linear factors, then solve the remaining polynomial.

Solution 3.57: Sketch

$P(1) = 1 - 10 + 15 - 6 = 0$, so $(x - 1)$ is a factor. Polynomial division gives $P(x) = (x - 1)(x^4 + x^3 + x^2 - 9x + 6)$. Continue factoring or use numerical/algebraic methods to find complex roots.

Problem 3.58: Expansion Result

Using De Moivre's theorem and the binomial expansion, derive the formula for $\cos 5\theta$ in terms of $\cos \theta$. Hence show that:

$$\cos 5\theta = 16 \cos^5 \theta - 20 \cos^3 \theta + 5 \cos \theta$$

Hint: Use Euler's formula: $(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^5 = \cos 5\theta + i \sin 5\theta$. Expand the left side using the binomial theorem, then equate real parts. Express $\sin^2 \theta$ in terms of $\cos \theta$ using $\sin^2 \theta = 1 - \cos^2 \theta$.

Solution 3.58: Sketch

By De Moivre's theorem:

$$(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^5 = \cos 5\theta + i \sin 5\theta$$

Expand the left side using binomial theorem:

$$\begin{aligned} (\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^5 &= \sum_{k=0}^5 \binom{5}{k} \cos^{5-k} \theta (i \sin \theta)^k \\ &= \binom{5}{0} \cos^5 \theta + \binom{5}{1} \cos^4 \theta (i \sin \theta) + \binom{5}{2} \cos^3 \theta (i \sin \theta)^2 \\ &\quad + \binom{5}{3} \cos^2 \theta (i \sin \theta)^3 + \binom{5}{4} \cos \theta (i \sin \theta)^4 + \binom{5}{5} (i \sin \theta)^5 \\ &= \cos^5 \theta + 5i \cos^4 \theta \sin \theta - 10 \cos^3 \theta \sin^2 \theta \\ &\quad - 10i \cos^2 \theta \sin^3 \theta + 5 \cos \theta \sin^4 \theta + i \sin^5 \theta \end{aligned}$$

Separate real and imaginary parts:

Real part:

$$\text{Re} = \cos^5 \theta - 10 \cos^3 \theta \sin^2 \theta + 5 \cos \theta \sin^4 \theta$$

This equals $\cos 5\theta$.

Express in terms of $\cos \theta$ only:

Use $\sin^2 \theta = 1 - \cos^2 \theta$:

$$\begin{aligned} \cos 5\theta &= \cos^5 \theta - 10 \cos^3 \theta (1 - \cos^2 \theta) + 5 \cos \theta (1 - \cos^2 \theta)^2 \\ &= \cos^5 \theta - 10 \cos^3 \theta + 10 \cos^5 \theta + 5 \cos \theta (1 - 2 \cos^2 \theta + \cos^4 \theta) \\ &= \cos^5 \theta - 10 \cos^3 \theta + 10 \cos^5 \theta + 5 \cos \theta - 10 \cos^3 \theta + 5 \cos^5 \theta \\ &= (1 + 10 + 5) \cos^5 \theta + (-10 - 10) \cos^3 \theta + 5 \cos \theta \\ &= 16 \cos^5 \theta - 20 \cos^3 \theta + 5 \cos \theta \end{aligned}$$

Therefore: $\cos 5\theta = 16 \cos^5 \theta - 20 \cos^3 \theta + 5 \cos \theta$ $\square$

Problem 3.59: Symmetry Identity

Show $\alpha^k + \alpha^{-k} = 2 \cos k\theta$ where $\alpha = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta$.

Hint: $\alpha = e^{i\theta}$ and $\alpha^{-1} = e^{-i\theta}$.

Solution 3.59: Sketch

$\alpha^k = e^{ik\theta} = \cos k\theta + i \sin k\theta$, $\alpha^{-k} = e^{-ik\theta} = \cos k\theta - i \sin k\theta$. Adding: $\alpha^k + \alpha^{-k} = 2 \cos k\theta$.

Problem 3.60: Equilateral Triangle Centroid

Let $\triangle ABC$ be an equilateral triangle with vertices A, B, C represented by complex numbers a, b, c respectively, oriented anticlockwise.

Let $\omega = e^{i2\pi/3} = \cos(2\pi/3) + i\sin(2\pi/3)$

be a primitive cube root of unity. Prove that the centroid of the triangle is at the origin if and only if:

$$a + b\omega + c\omega^2 = 0$$

Hint: For an equilateral triangle centered at the origin, the vertices are related by 120° rotations. Use the fact that $\omega = e^{i2\pi/3}$ satisfies $\omega^3 = 1$ and $1 + \omega + \omega^2 = 0$.

Solution 3.60: Sketch

Key facts about $\omega = e^{i2\pi/3}$:

- $\omega^3 = e^{i2\pi} = 1$ (cube root of unity)
- $1 + \omega + \omega^2 = 0$ (sum of cube roots of unity)
- $\omega = -\frac{1}{2} + i\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$

If the triangle is centered at origin:

For an equilateral triangle centered at the origin with one vertex at a , the other two vertices are obtained by rotating by 120° and 240° :

$$b = \omega a \quad \text{and} \quad c = \omega^2 a$$

Now compute:

$$\begin{aligned} a + b\omega + c\omega^2 &= a + (\omega a) \cdot \omega + (\omega^2 a) \cdot \omega^2 \\ &= a + \omega^2 a + \omega^4 a \\ &= a(1 + \omega^2 + \omega^4) \end{aligned}$$

Since $\omega^3 = 1$, we have $\omega^4 = \omega^3 \cdot \omega = 1 \cdot \omega = \omega$.

Therefore:

$$a + b\omega + c\omega^2 = a(1 + \omega^2 + \omega) = a(1 + \omega + \omega^2)$$

Using the fundamental identity $1 + \omega + \omega^2 = 0$:

$$a + b\omega + c\omega^2 = a \cdot 0 = 0$$

Conversely: If $a + b\omega + c\omega^2 = 0$ and the triangle is equilateral, then its centroid is at the origin.

The centroid is at $\frac{a+b+c}{3}$. For an equilateral triangle with the given property, we can show:

$$a + b + c = 0$$

This follows because if $a + b\omega + c\omega^2 = 0$, and we also have the relations for an equilateral triangle, then the centroid must be at the origin.

Therefore: $a + b\omega + c\omega^2 = 0$ $\square$

Geometric interpretation: This identity expresses the fact that in an equilateral triangle centered at the origin, the weighted sum of the vertices (with weights $1, \omega, \omega^2$) is zero, reflecting the rotational symmetry of the configuration.

Problem 3.61: Real Sum and Product

Given that $z + w$ and zw are both real, prove that either $z = \bar{w}$ or $\text{Im}(z) = \text{Im}(w) = 0$.

Hint: Let $z = a + bi$ and $w = c + di$. Use the conditions that $z + w$ and zw are real to derive equations for b and d in terms of a and c .

Solution 3.61: Proof

Let $z = a + bi$, $w = c + di$ where $a, b, c, d \in \mathbb{R}$.

Step 1: If $z + w$ is real, then $\text{Im}(z + w) = b + d = 0$, so $d = -b$. (Eq 1)

Step 2: If zw is real, then $\text{Im}(zw) = \text{Im}[(a + bi)(c + di)] = ad + bc = 0$. (Eq 2)

Step 3: Substitute Eq 1 into Eq 2: $a(-b) + bc = 0 \implies b(c - a) = 0$.

Case 1: If $b = 0$, then $d = -b = 0$, so $\text{Im}(z) = \text{Im}(w) = 0$ (both real).

Case 2: If $b \neq 0$, then $c = a$. With $d = -b$: $w = a - bi = \bar{z}$, so $z = \bar{w}$.

Conclusion: Either $\text{Im}(z) = \text{Im}(w) = 0$ (both real) or $z = \bar{w}$ (conjugates). $\square$

Problem 3.62: Complex Argument Region

The complex numbers w and z both have modulus 1, and $\frac{\pi}{2} < \text{Arg}\left(\frac{z}{w}\right) < \pi$, where Arg denotes the principal argument.

For real numbers x and y , consider the complex number $\frac{xz + yw}{z}$.

On an xy -plane, clearly sketch the region that contains all points (x, y) for which

$$\frac{\pi}{2} < \text{Arg}\left(\frac{xz + yw}{z}\right) < \pi.$$

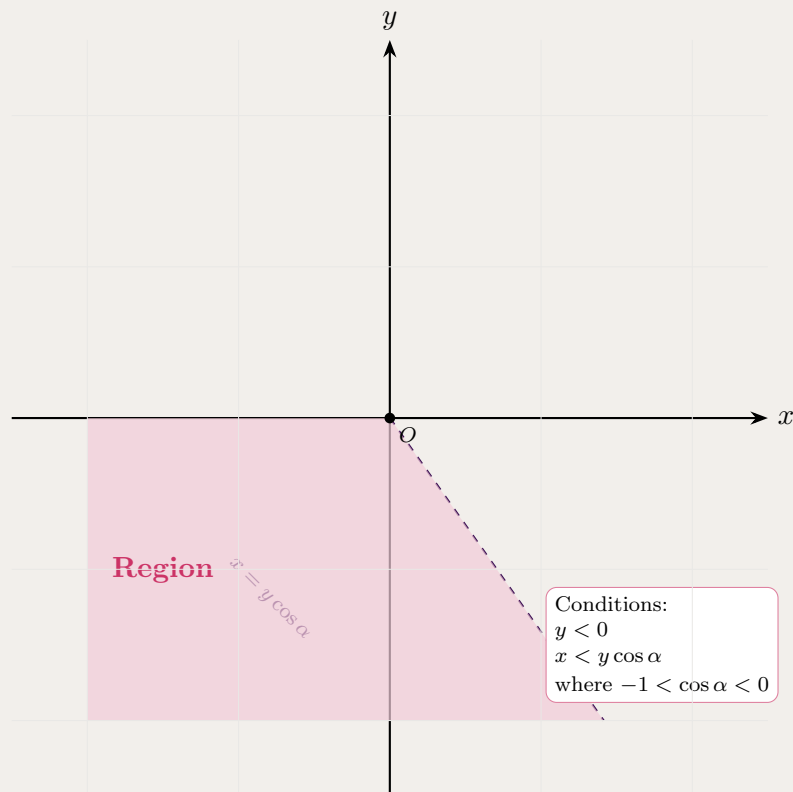
Hint: Simplify $\frac{xz + yw}{z} = x + y\frac{w}{z}$. Let $\alpha = \text{Arg}(w/z)$ where $\frac{\pi}{2} < \alpha < \pi$. Then $w/z = e^{i\alpha}$. The expression becomes $x + ye^{i\alpha}$. For the argument to be in the given range, the resulting complex number must lie in the second quadrant.

Solution 3.62: Sketch

Simplify: $\frac{xz+yw}{z} = x + y\frac{w}{z}$. Since $\frac{\pi}{2} < \text{Arg}(z/w) < \pi$, we have $-\pi < \text{Arg}(w/z) < -\frac{\pi}{2}$, so $w/z = e^{i\alpha}$ where $-\pi < \alpha < -\frac{\pi}{2}$. Thus:

$$x + y(\cos \alpha + i \sin \alpha) = (x + y \cos \alpha) + i(y \sin \alpha)$$

For this in Q2 (second quadrant): $x + y \cos \alpha < 0$ and $y \sin \alpha > 0$. Since $\sin \alpha < 0$ and $\cos \alpha < 0$ in Q3, we need $y < 0$ and $x < y \cos \alpha$. The region is a wedge below the x -axis bounded by the line $x = y \cos \alpha$.



Problem 3.63: Principal Square Root and Argument Locus

For a real number $x > 0$, the square root is denoted as $\sqrt{x}$ that $\sqrt{x} \cdot \sqrt{x} = x$ and it is unique.

We can extend this definition to complex numbers as follows, but koala in mind that the square root of a complex number is not unique.

Definition. Every non-zero complex number $w = re^{i\theta}$ has two square roots. If θ is the principal argument (that is, $-\pi < \theta \leq \pi$) of w , the **principal square root** $\sqrt{w}$ is

$$\sqrt{w} = \sqrt{r} e^{i\theta/2}.$$

Let z be a non-zero complex number with principal argument $-\pi < \arg(z) \leq \pi$.

(a) Using the definition above, show that

$$\sqrt{-z} = \begin{cases} -i\sqrt{z}, & 0 < \arg(z) \leq \pi, \\ i\sqrt{z}, & -\pi < \arg(z) \leq 0. \end{cases}$$

(b) Hence, solve $\sqrt{z} + \sqrt{-z} = 2$ for $z \in \mathbb{C}$.

(c) Let z_1 and z_2 be the solutions from part (b) with $\text{Im}(z_1) > 0$. A point P represents w on the Argand diagram. The locus of P satisfies

$$\arg\left(\frac{w - z_1}{w - z_2}\right) = \frac{\pi}{3}.$$

Find the Cartesian equation of this locus, describe its geometric shape, and state any necessary domain restrictions.

Hint:

- (a) Write $z = re^{i\theta}$. Multiplying by -1 rotates by π ; adjust $\arg(-z)$ into $(-\pi, \pi]$ by adding or subtracting π according to the quadrant of θ .
- (b) Split into the two cases from part (a). Solve for $\sqrt{z}$ first, square to obtain z , then verify $\arg(z)$ lies in the case you used.
- (c) Substitute $w = x + iy$ and $z_1 = 2i$, $z_2 = -2i$. Rationalise the denominator. For argument $\pi/3$, require positive real and imaginary parts, then use $\tan(\pi/3) = \sqrt{3}$.

Solution 3.63: Full Solution

Part (a). Let $z = re^{i\theta}$ with $r > 0$ and $-\pi < \theta \leq \pi$, so $\sqrt{z} = \sqrt{r}e^{i\theta/2}$.

Multiplying by -1 rotates z by π . To keep the principal argument in $(-\pi, \pi]$:

- If $0 < \theta \leq \pi$, then $\arg(-z) = \theta - \pi$ and

$$\sqrt{-z} = \sqrt{r}e^{i(\theta-\pi)/2} = \sqrt{r}e^{i\theta/2}e^{-i\pi/2} = -i\sqrt{z}.$$

- If $-\pi < \theta \leq 0$, then $\arg(-z) = \theta + \pi$ and

$$\sqrt{-z} = \sqrt{r}e^{i(\theta+\pi)/2} = \sqrt{r}e^{i\theta/2}e^{i\pi/2} = i\sqrt{z}.$$

Part (b).

- **Case 1** ($0 < \arg(z) \leq \pi$): $\sqrt{-z} = -i\sqrt{z}$ gives $\sqrt{z}(1-i) = 2$, so $\sqrt{z} = \frac{2}{1-i} = 1+i$ and $z = (1+i)^2 = 2i$.

Check: $\arg(2i) = \pi/2$.

- **Case 2** ($-\pi < \arg(z) \leq 0$): $\sqrt{-z} = i\sqrt{z}$ gives $\sqrt{z}(1+i) = 2$, so $\sqrt{z} = 1-i$ and $z = (1-i)^2 = -2i$.

Check: $\arg(-2i) = -\pi/2$.

Hence $z = \pm 2i$.

Part (c). Take $z_1 = 2i$, $z_2 = -2i$, and $w = x + iy$. Then

$$\frac{w - z_1}{w - z_2} = \frac{x + i(y-2)}{x + i(y+2)} = \frac{x^2 + y^2 - 4 - 4ix}{x^2 + (y+2)^2}.$$

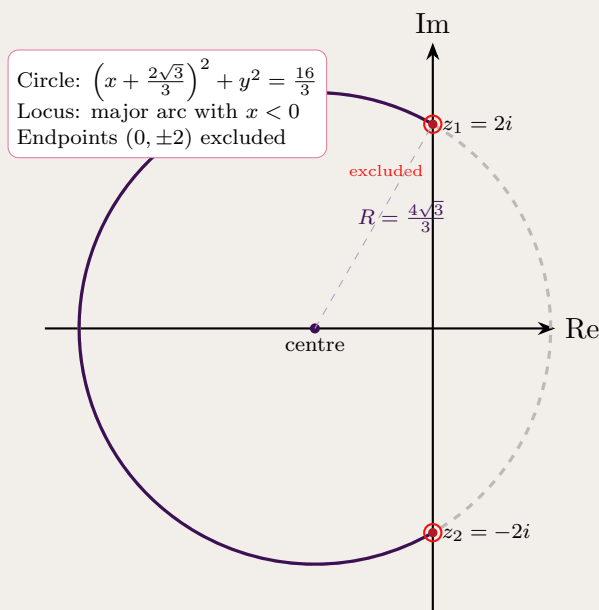
For $\arg(\cdot) = \pi/3$ (first quadrant), need $x^2 + y^2 - 4 > 0$ and $-4x > 0$, so $x < 0$. Also

$$\sqrt{3} = \frac{-4x}{x^2 + y^2 - 4} \implies x^2 + \frac{4\sqrt{3}}{3}x + y^2 = 4.$$

Completing the square in x :

$$\left(x + \frac{2\sqrt{3}}{3}\right)^2 + y^2 = \frac{16}{3}.$$

The locus is the major arc of the circle with centre $\left(-\frac{2\sqrt{3}}{3}, 0\right)$ and radius $\frac{4\sqrt{3}}{3}$, lying in the left half-plane ($x < 0$), with endpoints $(0, 2)$ and $(0, -2)$ excluded.



Takeaways 3.4

The formal definition of a single principal square root is a university-level complex analysis idea and is technically outside the NESAS Extension 2 syllabus (which usually expects two roots). Even so, this problem is excellent training: mastering case splits on the principal argument $(-\pi, \pi]$ is the kind of rigour needed for Band 6 Question 16-style work. The locus in part (c) is a circular arc from an angle condition—the same circle family as Apollonius-type loci, with domain restrictions from the quadrant of the argument.

Problem 3.64: Geometric Series with n -th Roots

If $z = \cos \frac{\pi}{n} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{n}$, and n is a positive integer, prove:

- (i) $1 + z + z^2 + \dots + z^{2n-1} = 0$
- (ii) $1 + z + z^2 + \dots + z^{n-1} = 1 + i \cot \left(\frac{\pi}{2n} \right)$

Hint: For part (i): Note that $z = e^{i\pi/n}$, so $z_n = e^{i2\pi} = 1$. Use the geometric series formula. For part (ii): Split the sum at z_{n-1} and use the fact that $z_n = e^{i\pi} = -1$.

Solution 3.64: Proof**Setup:** Given $z = \cos \frac{\pi}{n} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{n} = e^{i\pi/n}$ **Part (i):** Prove $1 + z + z^2 + \dots + z^{2n-1} = 0$ Calculate z^{2n} :

$$z^{2n} = \left(e^{i\pi/n}\right)^{2n} = e^{i \cdot 2\pi} = 1$$

Therefore z is a $2n$ -th root of unity.The sum $S = 1 + z + z^2 + \dots + z^{2n-1}$ is a geometric series with first term 1, common ratio z , and $2n$ terms.

Using the geometric series formula:

$$S = \frac{z^{2n} - 1}{z - 1} = \frac{1 - 1}{z - 1} = \frac{0}{z - 1} = 0$$

(Note: Since $z = e^{i\pi/n} \neq 1$ for $n \geq 2$, the denominator is non-zero.)Therefore: $1 + z + z^2 + \dots + z^{2n-1} = 0$ $\square$ **Part (ii):** Prove $1 + z + z^2 + \dots + z^{n-1} = 1 + i \cot\left(\frac{\pi}{2n}\right)$ Let $S_n = 1 + z + z^2 + \dots + z^{n-1}$

From part (i), we know:

$$1 + z + z^2 + \dots + z^{2n-1} = 0$$

We can split this sum:

$$(1 + z + \dots + z^{n-1}) + (z^n + z^{n+1} + \dots + z^{2n-1}) = 0$$

The second sum can be factored:

$$z^n + z^{n+1} + \dots + z^{2n-1} = z^n(1 + z + \dots + z^{n-1}) = z^n \cdot S_n$$

Since $z^n = e^{i\pi} = -1$:

$$S_n + (-1) \cdot S_n = 0$$

$$S_n - S_n = 0$$

Using geometric series: $S_n = \frac{z^n - 1}{z - 1} = \frac{-2}{z - 1}$ (since $z^n = -1$). With $z - 1 = (\cos \frac{\pi}{n} - 1) + i \sin \frac{\pi}{n}$, multiply by conjugate. Denominator: $2(1 - \cos \frac{\pi}{n}) = 4 \sin^2 \frac{\pi}{2n}$. Using $\cos \frac{\pi}{n} - 1 = -2 \sin^2 \frac{\pi}{2n}$ and $\sin \frac{\pi}{n} = 2 \sin \frac{\pi}{2n} \cos \frac{\pi}{2n}$, we get:

$$S_n = \frac{4 \sin^2 \frac{\pi}{2n} + i \cdot 4 \sin \frac{\pi}{2n} \cos \frac{\pi}{2n}}{4 \sin^2 \frac{\pi}{2n}} = 1 + i \cot \frac{\pi}{2n} \quad \square$$

Therefore: $1 + z + z^2 + \dots + z^{n-1} = 1 + i \cot\left(\frac{\pi}{2n}\right)$ $\square$ **Problem 3.65: Fifth Roots of -1 and Cosine Values**By finding the fifth roots of -1 , find the exact values of $\cos \frac{\pi}{5}$ and $\cos \frac{3\pi}{5}$.

Hint: The fifth roots of -1 are solutions to $z^5 = -1$, or equivalently $z^5 + 1 = 0$. Use $(1 + z)(1 + z^2 + z^4) = 0$. The polynomial $z^5 + 1$ factors as $(1 + z)(1 + z^2 + z^4)$, so $z = e^{i\pi/5}$ for $k = 0, 1, 2, 3, 4$. Use the quartic to find relationships involving $\cos \frac{\pi}{5}$ and $\cos \frac{3\pi}{5}$.

Solution 3.65: Sketch

Step 1: Solve $z^5 = -1 = e^{i\pi}$ using De Moivre: $z = e^{i\pi(2k+1)/5}$ for $k = 0, 1, 2, 3, 4$.

Five roots: $z_0 = e^{i\pi/5}$, $z_1 = e^{i3\pi/5}$, $z_2 = -1$, $z_3 = e^{-i3\pi/5} = \bar{z}_1$, $z_4 = e^{-i\pi/5} = \bar{z}_0$.

Step 2: Factor: $z^5 + 1 = (z + 1)(z^4 - z^3 + z^2 - z + 1) = 0$. The four non-real roots $z_0, z_1, \bar{z}_0, \bar{z}_1$ satisfy $z^4 - z^3 + z^2 - z + 1 = 0$.

Step 3: Use Vieta's formulas

Sum of roots: $(z_0 + \bar{z}_0) + (z_1 + \bar{z}_1) = 1 \implies 2\cos\frac{\pi}{5} + 2\cos\frac{3\pi}{5} = 1 \implies \cos\frac{\pi}{5} + \cos\frac{3\pi}{5} = \frac{1}{2}$.

Sum of products (coeff. of z^2): Using $z_0 z_4 = |z_0|^2 = 1$, $z_1 z_3 = |z_1|^2 = 1$, and simplifying other products gives: $\alpha\beta = -\frac{1}{4}$ where $\alpha = \cos\frac{\pi}{5}$ and $\beta = \cos\frac{3\pi}{5}$.

From $\alpha + \beta = \frac{1}{2}$ and $\alpha\beta = -\frac{1}{4}$, solve $4t^2 - 2t - 1 = 0$ to get $t = \frac{1 \pm \sqrt{5}}{4}$. Since $\cos\frac{\pi}{5} > 0$ and $\cos\frac{3\pi}{5} < 0$:

$$\boxed{\cos\frac{\pi}{5} = \frac{1 + \sqrt{5}}{4}} \quad \text{and} \quad \boxed{\cos\frac{3\pi}{5} = \frac{1 - \sqrt{5}}{4}}$$

Problem 3.66: Euler's Formula and Integration

(i) Show that for any integer n , $e^{in\theta} + e^{-in\theta} = 2\cos(n\theta)$.

(ii) By expanding $(e^{i\theta} + e^{-i\theta})^4$, show that

$$\cos^4\theta = \frac{1}{8}(\cos(4\theta) + 4\cos(2\theta) + 3).$$

(iii) Hence, or otherwise, find $\int_0^{\pi/2} \cos^4\theta \, d\theta$.

Hint: For part (i): Use Euler's formula $e^{i\phi} = \cos\phi + i\sin\phi$. For part (ii): Use part (i) to write $e^{i\theta} + e^{-i\theta} = 2\cos\theta$, then raise to the 4th power using the binomial theorem. For part (iii): Integrate the expression from part (ii) term by term.

Solution 3.66: Sketch

Part (i): Show $e^{in\theta} + e^{-in\theta} = 2\cos(n\theta)$

Using Euler's formula:

$$e^{in\theta} = \cos(n\theta) + i\sin(n\theta)$$

$$e^{-in\theta} = \cos(-n\theta) + i\sin(-n\theta) = \cos(n\theta) - i\sin(n\theta)$$

Adding:

$$e^{in\theta} + e^{-in\theta} = 2\cos(n\theta) \quad \square$$

(ii) From (i), $\cos\theta = \frac{e^{i\theta} + e^{-i\theta}}{2}$, so $\cos^4\theta = \frac{(e^{i\theta} + e^{-i\theta})^4}{16}$. Expand using binomial: $(e^{i\theta} + e^{-i\theta})^4 = e^{i4\theta} + 4e^{i2\theta} + 6 + 4e^{-i2\theta} + e^{-i4\theta} = 2\cos 4\theta + 8\cos 2\theta + 6$. Thus $\cos^4\theta = \frac{1}{8}(\cos 4\theta + 4\cos 2\theta + 3)$. $\square$

$$\text{(iii)} \quad \int_0^{\pi/2} \cos^4\theta \, d\theta = \frac{1}{8} \left[\frac{\sin 4\theta}{4} + 2\sin 2\theta + 3\theta \right]_0^{\pi/2} = \frac{1}{8} \cdot \frac{3\pi}{2} = \boxed{\frac{3\pi}{16}}$$

Problem 3.67: Bounding Complex Magnitude

Let z be a complex number such that $|z| = 1$. Let $z = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta$.

- (i) Show that $|z^3 - z + 2|^2 = 6 - 2 \cos 2\theta + 4 \cos 3\theta - 4 \cos \theta$.
- (ii) Letting $x = \cos \theta$, show that $|z^3 - z + 2|^2$ can be expressed as the polynomial $P(x)$, where $P(x) = 16x^3 - 4x^2 - 16x + 8$.
(You are given that $\cos 3\theta = 4 \cos^3 \theta - 3 \cos \theta$)
- (iii) Find the critical values of the polynomial $P(x)$ in the domain $-1 \leq x \leq 1$.
- (iv) Hence, or otherwise, determine the maximum value of $|z^3 - z + 2|$.

Hint:

- (i) Use De Moivre's Theorem to express z^3 , separate into real and imaginary parts, and apply $|w|^2 = \operatorname{Re}(w)^2 + \operatorname{Im}(w)^2$. The compound angle formula $\cos(A - B)$ cleans up the cross-terms.
- (ii) Substitute the given identity for $\cos 3\theta$, and use $\cos 2\theta = 2x^2 - 1$.
- (iii) Differentiate $P(x)$, set $P'(x) = 0$, and factor the quadratic to find turning points.
- (iv) Test critical values and the domain endpoints ($x = 1, -1$) in $P(x)$. Remember to take the square root of the maximum value.

Solution 3.67: Sketch

(i) $z^3 = \cos 3\theta + i \sin 3\theta$.
 $z^3 - z + 2 = (\cos 3\theta - \cos \theta + 2) + i(\sin 3\theta - \sin \theta)$.
 $|z^3 - z + 2|^2 = (\cos 3\theta - \cos \theta + 2)^2 + (\sin 3\theta - \sin \theta)^2$
 $= (\cos^2 3\theta + \sin^2 3\theta) + (\cos^2 \theta + \sin^2 \theta) + 4 - 2(\cos 3\theta \cos \theta + \sin 3\theta \sin \theta) + 4 \cos 3\theta - 4 \cos \theta$
 $= 6 - 2 \cos(3\theta - \theta) + 4 \cos 3\theta - 4 \cos \theta$
 $= 6 - 2 \cos 2\theta + 4 \cos 3\theta - 4 \cos \theta$
(ii) Substitute $\cos 2\theta = 2x^2 - 1$ and $\cos 3\theta = 4x^3 - 3x$:
 $P(x) = 6 - 2(2x^2 - 1) + 4(4x^3 - 3x) - 4x$
 $P(x) = 6 - 4x^2 + 2 + 16x^3 - 12x - 4x$
 $P(x) = 16x^3 - 4x^2 - 16x + 8$
(iii) $P'(x) = 48x^2 - 8x - 16$.
Set $P'(x) = 0 \implies 6x^2 - x - 2 = 0 \implies (3x - 2)(2x + 1) = 0$.
Critical values: $x = \frac{2}{3}, -\frac{1}{2}$, both in $[-1, 1]$.
(iv) Test endpoints and critical values:
 $P(1) = 4, P(-1) = 4, P(\frac{2}{3}) = \frac{8}{27}, P(-\frac{1}{2}) = 13$.
Maximum $|z^3 - z + 2|^2 = 13$. Maximum value of $|z^3 - z + 2|$ is $\sqrt{13}$.

Takeaways 3.5

- **Bridging Domains:** Converting a complex magnitude problem into a real-variable calculus problem is a powerful technique for bounding.
- **Endpoint Checks:** Reinforces that students must check domain endpoints for global maximums.

A Appendix: Out-of-Syllabus Enrichment

A.1 Coordinate Form of Complex Rotation

Syllabus note: The coordinate formulation below is out of syllabus for HSC Mathematics Extension 1 and Extension 2.

Coordinate form (or Matrix form): Writing $z = x + iy$ and $z' = x' + iy'$, the rotation by angle ϕ is equivalent to the pair of equations

$$\begin{pmatrix} x' \\ y' \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \phi & -\sin \phi \\ \sin \phi & \cos \phi \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix}$$

B Roots of Complex Numbers

B.1 Real vs. Complex Roots

In the real number system, the principal root of a positive number is unique (e.g., $\sqrt{2} \approx 1.414$). However, in the complex plane, roots are not unique. Because complex numbers encode rotations, extracting a root involves dividing an angle, which introduces multiple valid solutions spaced equally around the origin.

B.2 The n -th Roots Formula

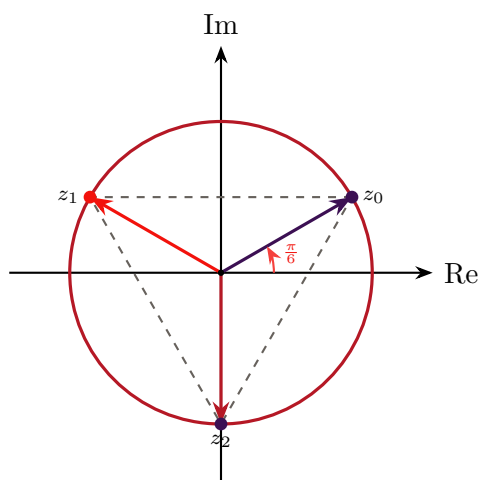
For any complex number $z \in \mathbb{C}$ expressed in modulus-argument form as

$$z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta),$$

and for any integer $n > 1$, the expression $z^{\frac{1}{n}}$ has exactly n distinct values.

Using De Moivre's Theorem, these roots are generated by the formula:

$$z_k = r^{\frac{1}{n}} \left(\cos \left(\frac{\theta + 2k\pi}{n} \right) + i \sin \left(\frac{\theta + 2k\pi}{n} \right) \right), \quad k = 0, 1, 2, \dots, n-1.$$



Three cube roots of $8i$ inscribed in a circle of radius 2

Geometric note: These n roots form the vertices of a regular n -gon inscribed in a circle of radius $r^{\frac{1}{n}}$ centred at the origin. Adjacent roots are separated by an angle of $\frac{2\pi}{n}$.

B.3 Enrichment: Principal Root (Outside NESA Syllabus)

Syllabus note: The following is beyond the NESA HSC Extension 2 scope and is provided for enrichment only.

While the NESA syllabus requires finding and plotting all n roots, higher mathematics (such as complex analysis) often defines a *principal root* to ensure functions remain single-valued. The principal n -th root is the specific root corresponding to $k = 0$, provided the original argument θ is restricted to its principal value $-\pi < \theta \leq \pi$.

B.4 Worked Example

Question: Find the cube roots of $z = 8i$ in Cartesian form.

Solution:

First, express $z = 8i$ in modulus-argument form:

$$z = 8\left(\cos\frac{\pi}{2} + i\sin\frac{\pi}{2}\right).$$

Here $r = 8$, $\theta = \frac{\pi}{2}$, and $n = 3$. The modulus of each root is $8^{\frac{1}{3}} = 2$.

Applying the roots formula for $k = 0, 1, 2$:

$$z_k = 2\left(\cos\left(\frac{\frac{\pi}{2} + 2k\pi}{3}\right) + i\sin\left(\frac{\frac{\pi}{2} + 2k\pi}{3}\right)\right).$$

• For $k = 0$:

$$z_0 = 2\left(\cos\frac{\pi}{6} + i\sin\frac{\pi}{6}\right) = 2\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} + i\frac{1}{2}\right) = \sqrt{3} + i.$$

• For $k = 1$:

$$z_1 = 2\left(\cos\frac{5\pi}{6} + i\sin\frac{5\pi}{6}\right) = 2\left(-\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} + i\frac{1}{2}\right) = -\sqrt{3} + i.$$

• For $k = 2$:

$$z_2 = 2\left(\cos\frac{9\pi}{6} + i\sin\frac{9\pi}{6}\right) = 2\left(\cos\frac{3\pi}{2} + i\sin\frac{3\pi}{2}\right) = -2i.$$

Answer: The three cube roots of $8i$ are $\sqrt{3} + i$, $-\sqrt{3} + i$, and $-2i$.

C Partial Fraction Decomposition over $\mathbb{C}$

Theorem: By the Fundamental Theorem of Algebra, any polynomial $D(z)$ can be completely factored into linear factors over the complex numbers $\mathbb{C}$.

Consequently, any proper rational function $\frac{N(z)}{D(z)}$ can be decomposed entirely into partial fractions whose denominators are powers of these linear factors. If a complex root α has a multiplicity of m (i.e., $(z - \alpha)^m$ is a factor of $D(z)$), its decomposition includes m terms:

$$\frac{N(z)}{D(z)} = \cdots + \frac{A_1}{z - \alpha} + \frac{A_2}{(z - \alpha)^2} + \cdots + \frac{A_m}{(z - \alpha)^m} + \cdots$$

where $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_m \in \mathbb{C}$.

C.1 The Contrast: $\mathbb{C}$ vs $\mathbb{R}$

- Over $\mathbb{R}$: Irreducible quadratics force linear numerators $Bx + C$.
- Over $\mathbb{C}$: All factors are linear, so numerators are constants.

C.2 Solution Outline for $f(z) = \frac{1}{z^3-1}$

Factor $z^3 - 1 = (z - 1)(z - \omega)(z - \bar{\omega})$. Write

$$\frac{1}{z^3 - 1} = \frac{A_1}{z - 1} + \frac{A_2}{z - \omega} + \frac{A_3}{z - \bar{\omega}},$$

where $A_k = \frac{1}{(z^3-1)'} \Big|_{z=\alpha_k} = \frac{1}{3\alpha_k^2}$. Thus $A_1 = 1/3$, $A_2 = 1/(3\omega^2)$, $A_3 = 1/(3\bar{\omega}^2)$. Adding the conjugate pair yields the real partial fraction if required.

C.3 Solution Outline for $f(x) = \frac{1}{x^3-1}$ over $\mathbb{R}$

Factor $x^3 - 1 = (x - 1)(x^2 + x + 1)$. Write

$$\frac{1}{x^3 - 1} = \frac{A}{x - 1} + \frac{Bx + C}{x^2 + x + 1},$$

Determine A, B, C by equating numerators (or cover-up for A). Results: $A = \frac{1}{3}$, $B = -\frac{1}{3}$, $C = \frac{2}{3}$. Thus

$$\frac{1}{x^3 - 1} = \frac{1/3}{x - 1} + \frac{-\frac{1}{3}x + \frac{2}{3}}{x^2 + x + 1}.$$

C.4 Takeaways for HSC Extension 2

- **The Recombination Trick:** If asked to find the partial fractions over $\mathbb{R}$, it is often much faster to decompose over $\mathbb{C}$ first. Once you have the complex fractions, adding the conjugate pairs $\frac{A_2}{x-\omega} + \frac{A_3}{x-\bar{\omega}}$ back together will naturally collapse them into the required real fraction $\frac{Bx+C}{x^2+x+1}$.
- **Roots of Unity Integration:** When integrating functions involving denominators like $x^n \pm 1$, utilizing complex roots of unity allows you to sidestep brutal algebraic manipulation.

D Conclusion

Complex numbers are a core component of the HSC Mathematics Extension 2 course. Mastery comes from repeated, reflective practice across all forms—Cartesian, polar, and exponential—and understanding their geometric interpretations. Use these problems to sharpen the ability to convert between forms, apply De Moivre's theorem, interpret loci geometrically, and communicate complete mathematical reasoning. Best of luck with your studies and HSC examinations!

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